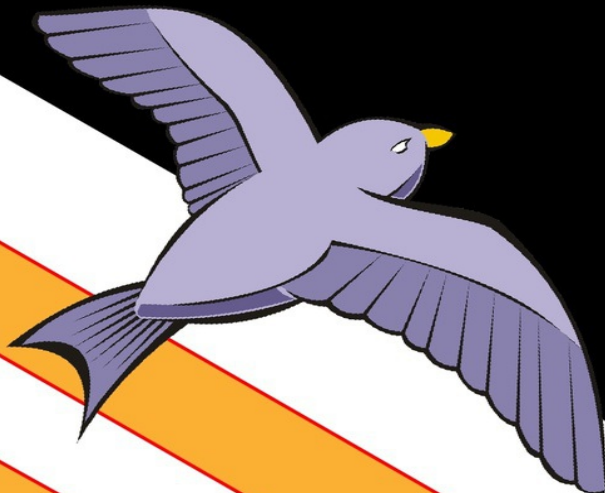


# ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR FOR BEGINNERS 2020 - 2021

*A Step By Step Guide*



**RICHARD  
STEVE**

**A D O B E**  
**I L L U S T R A T O R**  
**FOR BEGINNERS**  
**2020 – 2021**

***A Step By Step Guide***

Richard

Steve

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Printed in the United States of America

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RS Publishing House

USA | UK | CANADA

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# INTRODUCTION

The creation of digital and printed images has been increasing tremendously, much more with the various technological developments.

Adobe Illustrator has helped many users create unique images, including artworks, drawings, and illustrations. Hence, various visual artists, web designers, graphic designers, and expertise illustrators use the sophisticated tools provided on this platform to create designs.

Therefore, this eBook aims to guide beginners on how to achieve great creativity using Adobe Illustrator. As a guide, this book would provide you with a simplified explanation of using this platform by revealing the various areas and tools available on this platform. Hence, you get to learn about the use of Adobe Illustrator, including creating a sketch, colorful vector images, texts, shortcuts, tips and tricks, and more.

# 1.

## GETTING STARTED

In this chapter, we will be exploring the fundamentals of Adobe Illustrator. Getting the Adobe Illustrator is one way of getting yourself started utilizing Adobe Illustrator; however, you need to know your way around the Illustrator. You would also need to identify every tool and control panel in your workspaces. This chapter would introduce you to all the essential tools you have readily available on the Illustrator and how you can effectively maximize them.

We would briefly consider the following;

- The Tools Panel
- The Control Panel
- Workspace Panels
- The Document Area
- Setting Up a New Document

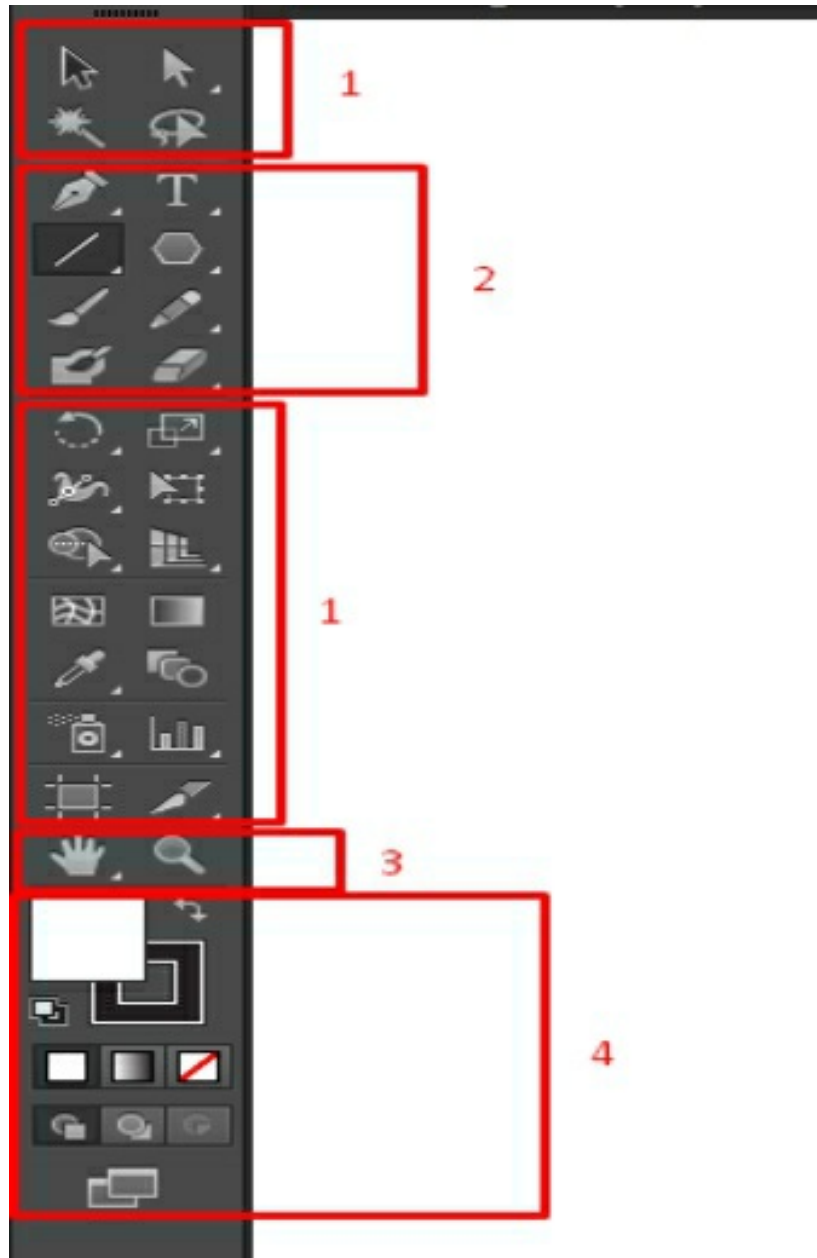
They are the necessary working equipment on adobe illustrator every novice should learn to create great designs.

## THE TOOLS PANEL

This tool is one crucial segment of adobe illustrator because you can use it to edit, manipulate, customize, colorize, and make illustrations. This panel allows you to click and drag objects and place them in the desired position. You should get familiar with the concept of "click and drag" as it would often be used in your illustrations.

The ***Tools panel*** has major four sections:

1. The ***Edit Section*** is used for containing your drawing, selection, and painting tools.
2. The ***Shape Section*** allows you to draw different shapes.
3. The ***Display Section*** is used for panning and zooming your work area.
4. The ***Color Section*** allows you to stroke and fill any part of your work with colors.

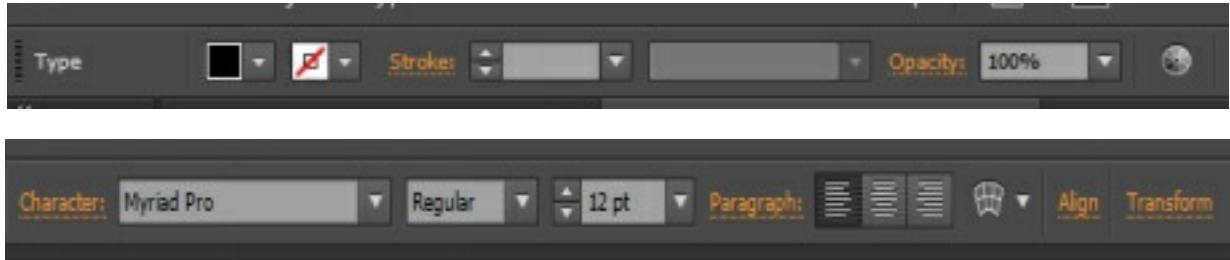


*The image above shows those grouped sections with appropriate numbering.*

## THE CONTROL PANEL

The control panel gives you the avenue to options that are related to the selected object/tool. The control panel is at the top of your entire workspace.

It has different options depending on the type of object/tool that you have chosen. If you selected a text object/tool, your control panel would display options for text formatting with other supplementary options like placement, the object's dimension, and color.



If the Control board text is a hyperlink, you can select the content to reveal a related discourse box. You can click on the word "Stroke" to show its board.

### **Changing the controls that show in your Control panel**

- You can either check or uncheck options available on the menu.

### **Enter or exit exchange box from Control panel**

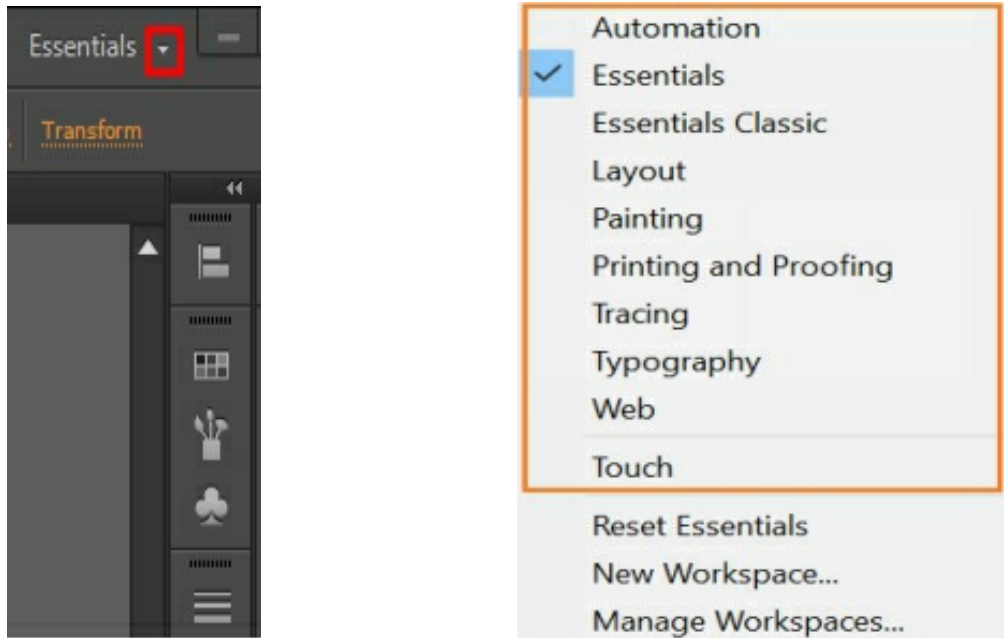
- Select any hyperlinked word to open its relevant content.
- Select areas outside the panel box to terminate it.

### **Docking the control panel to the base of the workspace**

- You can get it done by selecting "dock to bottom" from the Control panel menu at the right corner.

## **THE WORKSPACE PANELS**

Between making sense of the 250+ menu things to do and revamping palettes (until you have a little zone on your archive wherein you can work), you may discover the Illustrator condition somewhat overwhelming. (If you do, you're a long way from alone.) The following segments are a review of all the stuff that is keeping you from completing any work. Illustrator gives you ten distinct workspaces. The default workspace is Essentials.

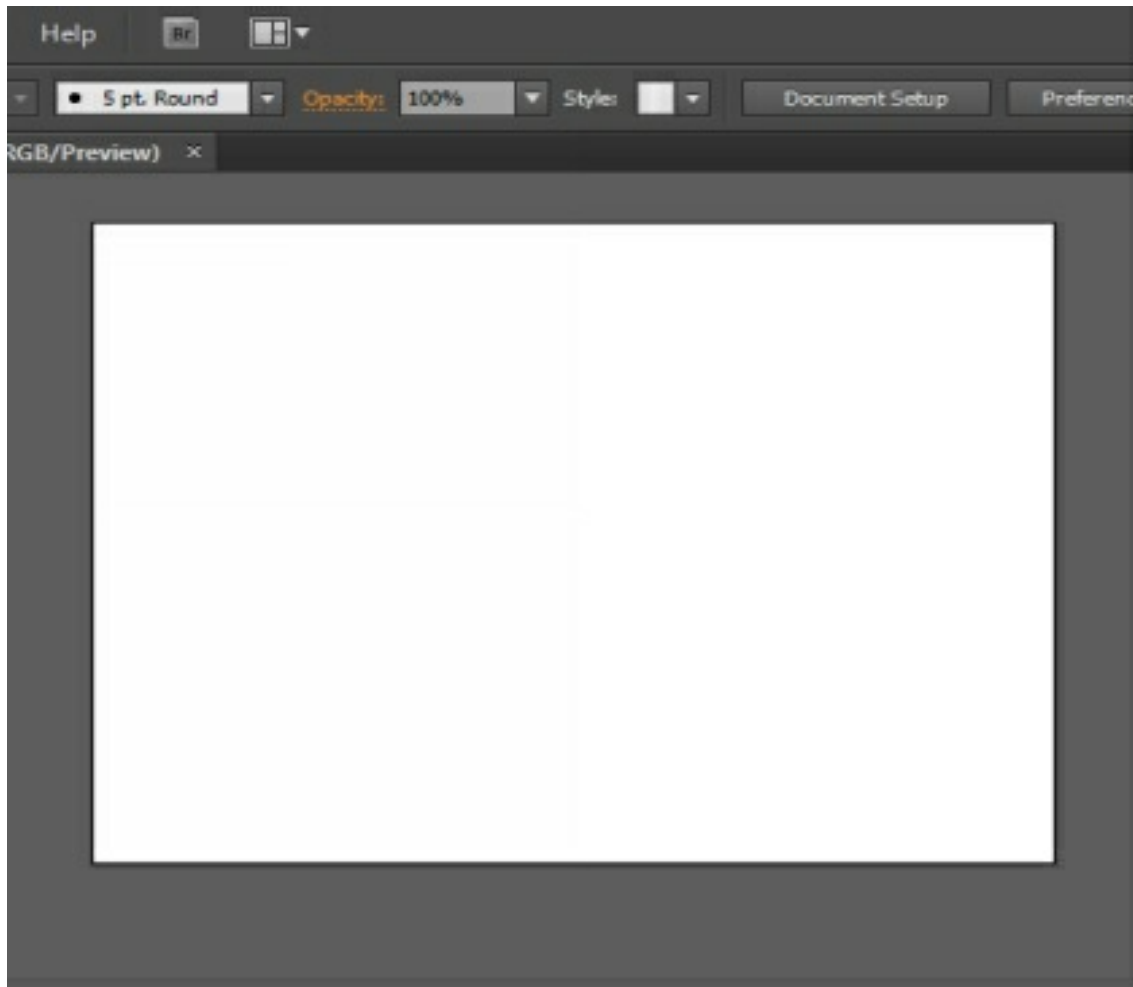


- If you change any application dimension, all its content of the application resizes it appropriately, so there is no lag or overlaps.
- The Application bar over the top has a workspace switcher, menus, and additional application controls.
- The toolbar contains instruments for making and altering pictures, work of art, page components, etc. Related devices are all together here.
- The Control board shows choices for chosen objects.
- The Document window shows what you are working on, and you can select the Document windows. It could also be together or grouped if necessary.
- Panel assists you with observing and altering your work. Boards can be free-floating or docked.

## THE DOCUMENT AREA

Illustrator utilizes a customary work board as a similitude; you see it when there is another file creation. You have the page you're dealing with (the Artboard), and the table the page sits on (called the Scratch zone, yet conventional specialists will see it as a Pasteboard). Whenever you make

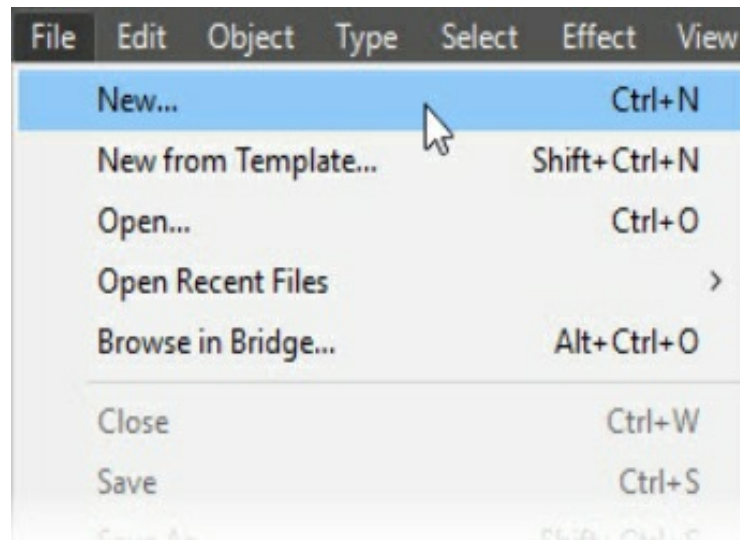
another report, the Artboard shows up as a square shape in a white scope. (The Artboard's real size and state rely upon what you enter for height and width whenever you create a new document.)



## SETTING UP A NEW DOCUMENT

When working with adobe illustrator, sometimes you will want to create a new document, and some other time, you may consider using the existing materials you have saved before now.

To create a new document in adobe illustrator is very easy. Here is how to create one;



**Choose a file then select new.**

Once you select New, a new document window pops up, including the document name, new document profile, size, unit page orientation, whether portrait or landscape and several Artboards in the document.



## New Document

Name:

Profile:

Number of Artboards:     

Spacing:  Columns:

Size:

Width:  Units:

Height:  Orientation:  

Bleed:     

▼ Advanced

Color Mode:  

Raster Effects:

Preview Mode:

☐ Align New Objects to Pixel Grid

### Type a name in the text box available for the name field

You can immediately give your new document a name as soon as the new document window pops up, or you can name it when you want to save or close the document.

### Select a profile from the new doc profile drop-down

Select the drop-down arrow to know the settings for each profile and to make

adjustments wherever necessary.

### **In the number of Artboards field, input the amount you need**

If peradventure you need just two documents, input 2 in the box

### **Spacing text field**

Simply input the number of spacing you want between each Artboard.

### **Size (width and height) text field**

You can select from the drop-down list or simply input the weight and height value you want in the text box.

### **Unit box field**

You can simply pick the unit of measurement you are most comfortable with from the drop-down list.

### **Artboard orientation**

There are two options as regards orientation; portrait or landscape. The one you decide to choose will determine how your document will look like when you printout your work.

### **Bleed text field**

Bleed value is the measurement of the area an image covers outside the Artboard.

Bleed value is not often available on various projects. But if your project demands you use it, simply input an amount in the text box.

After that, click OK to close the windows and effect the various value changes.

## **SUMMARY**

You have it here, the starter pack to get you ready on using adobe illustration.

We have covered the pure basis of identifying and locating where you can find your Tool panel, Control panel, Workspace panel, Document area, and Setting up a new document. The preceding chapter would teach how you can effectively maximize them all.

## 2.

# GETTING TO KNOW THE PANELS AND WORKSPACES

In this chapter, we will be exploring the panels and workspace of Adobe Illustrator. Chapter one showed the basics tools you need to be familiar with and how to work with them. However, this section would explain how you can optimize those essentials for quality designs. This chapter would familiarize you with your panel, workspace, and all you need to know in getting you ready to use your workspace.

### THE PANELS

The Illustrator Toolbox panel is the spot that the vast majority starts when they use Illustrator. In the wake of giving you 24 devices, six alien buttons, and a pack of mammoth square things, the Toolbox poses to be just that simple. In reality, the Toolbox has more than 50 hidden but useful tools.

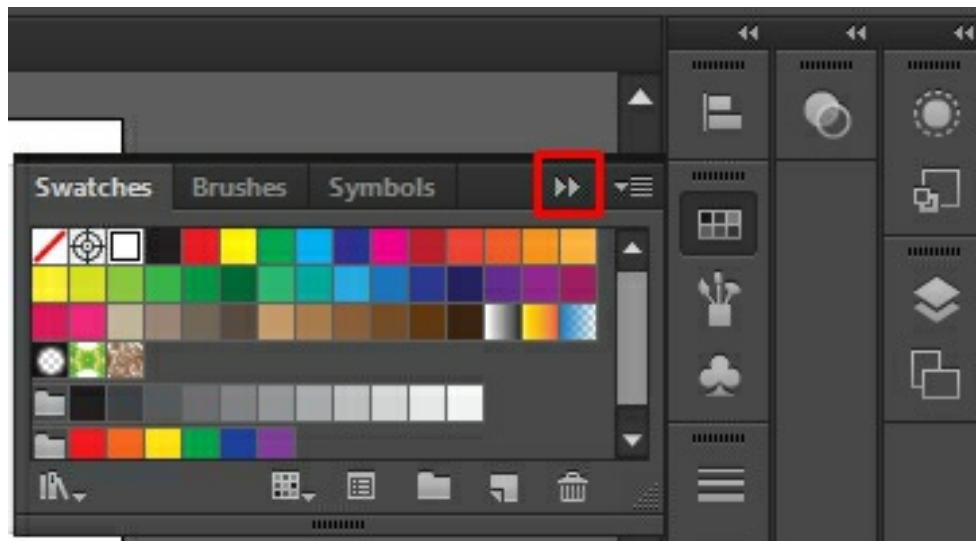
The tools in the tool slots are the options inside the Toolbox. Numerous tool slots contain more than one apparatus, as shown by a little dark arrow in the tool slot's top right corner.

## Modifying the Workspace panel

To include or remove instruments from the Workspace panel, click the Window tab and select the workspace panel to modify.

It pops out a dialog.

That can be dragged to the right side of your interface for better positioning.



## CREATING A WORKSPACE

The tool panels are on either side structure of the workspace for use. Now,

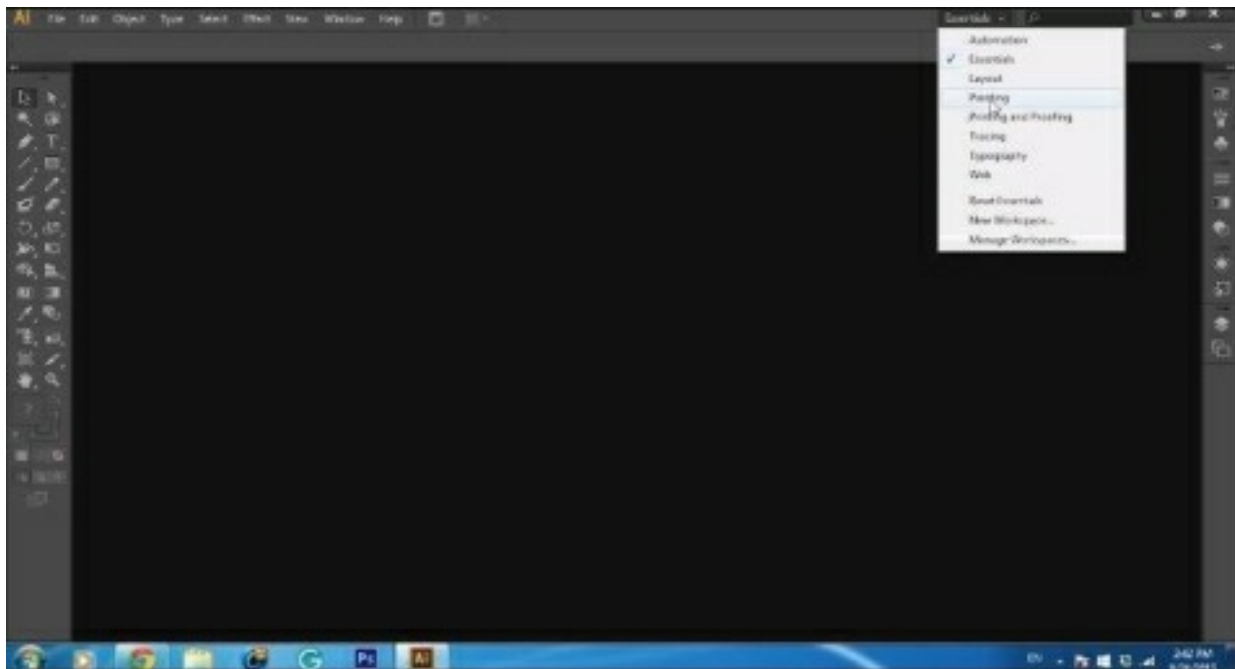
1. Select "Essentials" in the upper right-hand

You would see a drop-down menu.

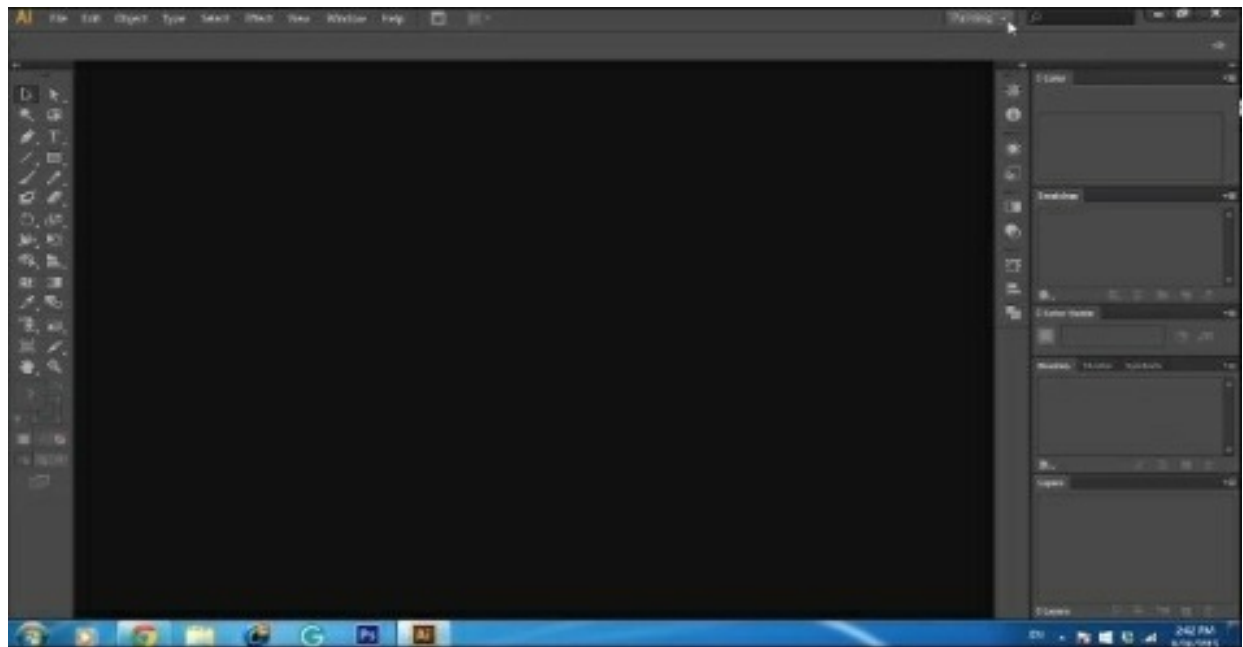
2. You can click

- "Essentials" It is always pre-selected (checked). This "Essential" is the default setting, which is for the most part. The general purpose of changing your workspace is to make your activity simpler. It is time-saving;
- "Automation." It is as far as anyone knows speedier;
- "Painting." You use it to paint pictures;
- "Tracing." It works with pixel pictures;
- "Typography";
- "Web." You use this for designs going to the internet.

Click the "Painting" workspace. It will change the right-side toolbar.



3. Select the workspace drop-down menu once more



4. Select "Web"

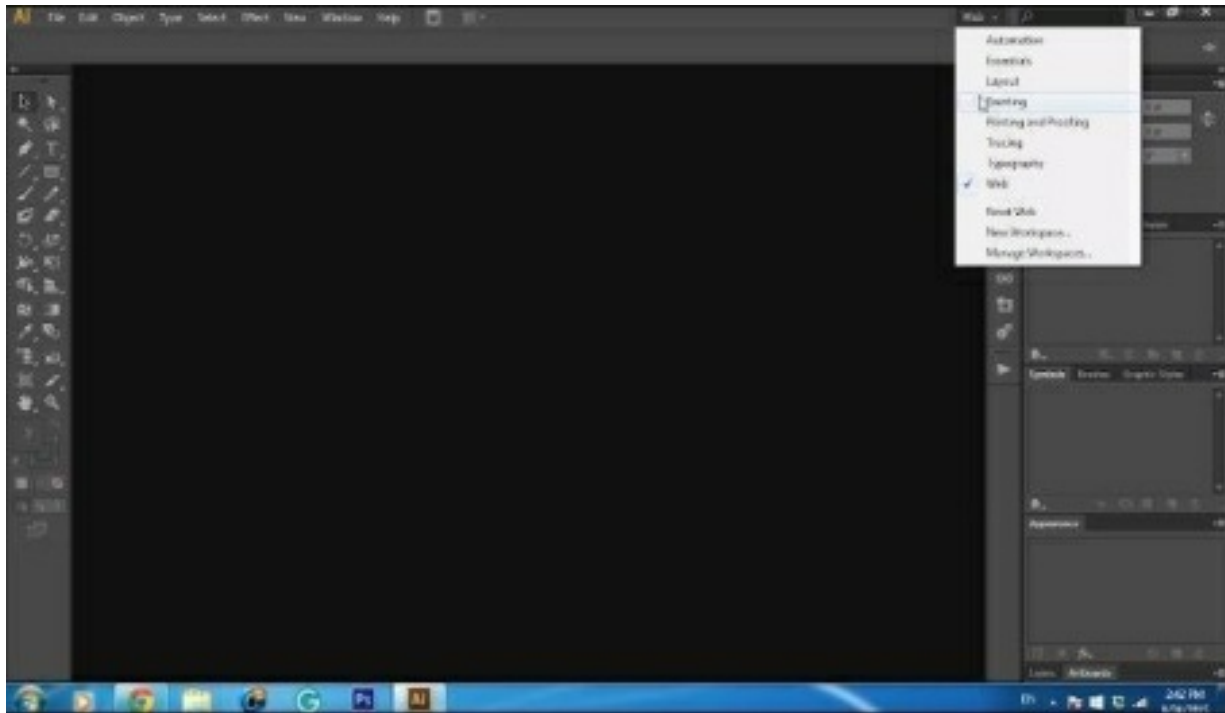
It will change the toolbar on the right.



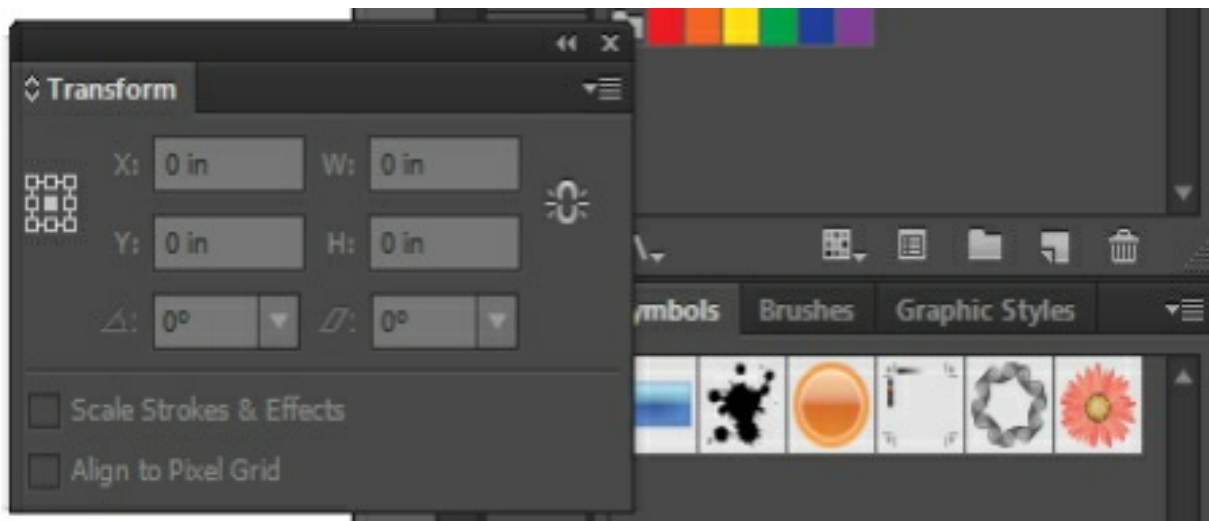
5. We should tap the workspace drop-down menu once more.
6. Select "Painting" once more

You can modify the apparatuses that you'd prefer to see.

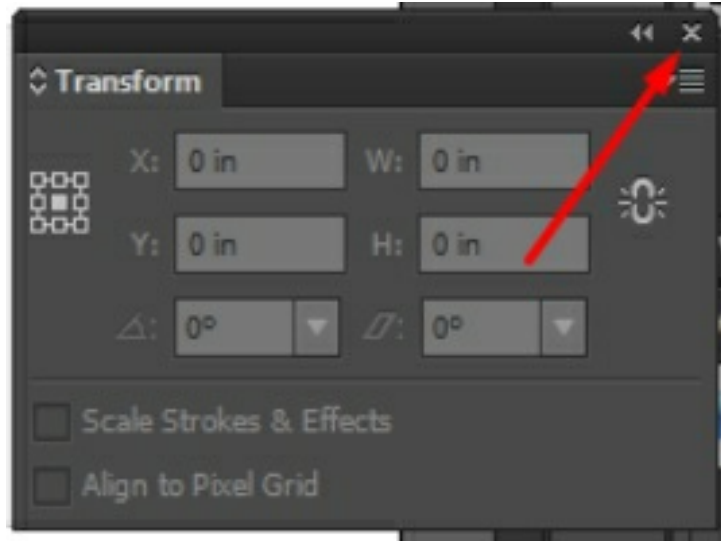




7. On the off chance that you generally work with layers, select and drag the "Layers" segment up for more space
8. If you want to get rid of the "Symbols" tab, select and drag it onto the main workspace



9. Click the cross in the upper right corner to kill the "Symbols" tab.



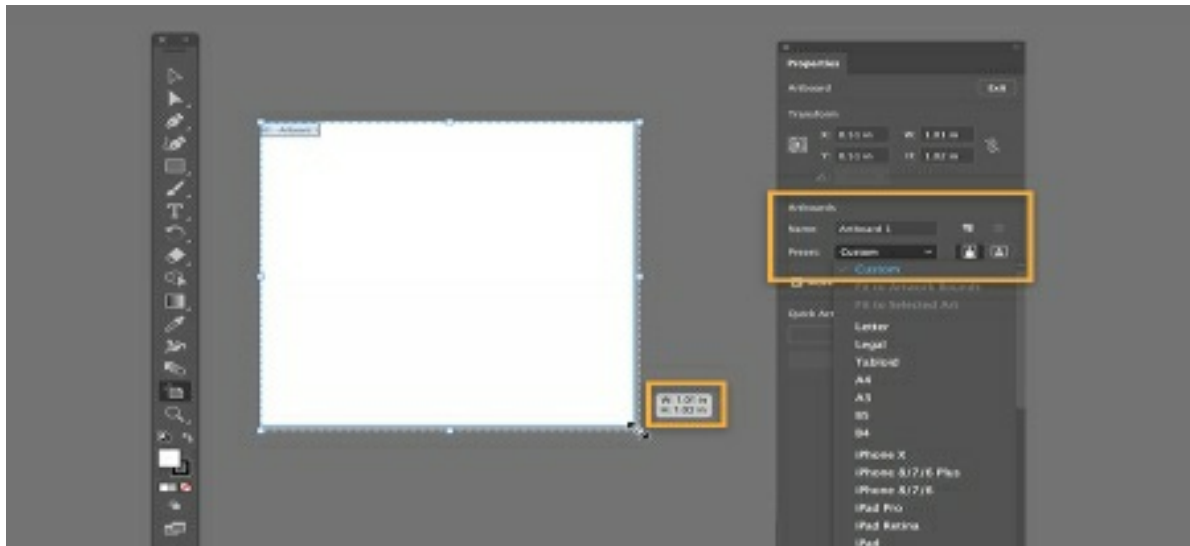
## SUMMARY

By now, you should know your way around the panel and workspace. Getting it started and also starting your illustration can subtly come in soon; however, there are still some things you need to learn about your worksheet (Artboard), which is in the next chapter. You could do well to practice what you learned so far just so it becomes innate.

# 3.

## UNDERSTANDING THE ARTBOARDS

In this chapter, we will be exploring the Artboard panels and their tools. Although you know the basics, you might also consent that you are far from being an expert but far better than a novice. This section would help push your knowledge of adobe forward by procuring you with methods to utilize your Artboard panel properly.



## THE ARTBOARD PANEL

## WORKING WITH THE ARTBOARD

- Artboards are like pages in Adobe InDesign or Microsoft Word, and they are the printable region.
- Artboards can vary in sizes and directions, how you like it.
- The Artboard you are currently using is the active Artboard. Commands like **Ctrl + 0** or the View tab -> Fit Artboard in Window will place your Artboard properly.
- The Artboards board (Window -> Artboards) is another approach to explore Artboards.
- The Artboard route menu in the lower-left corner of the Document window shows a similar posting of Artboards as in the Artboards board.

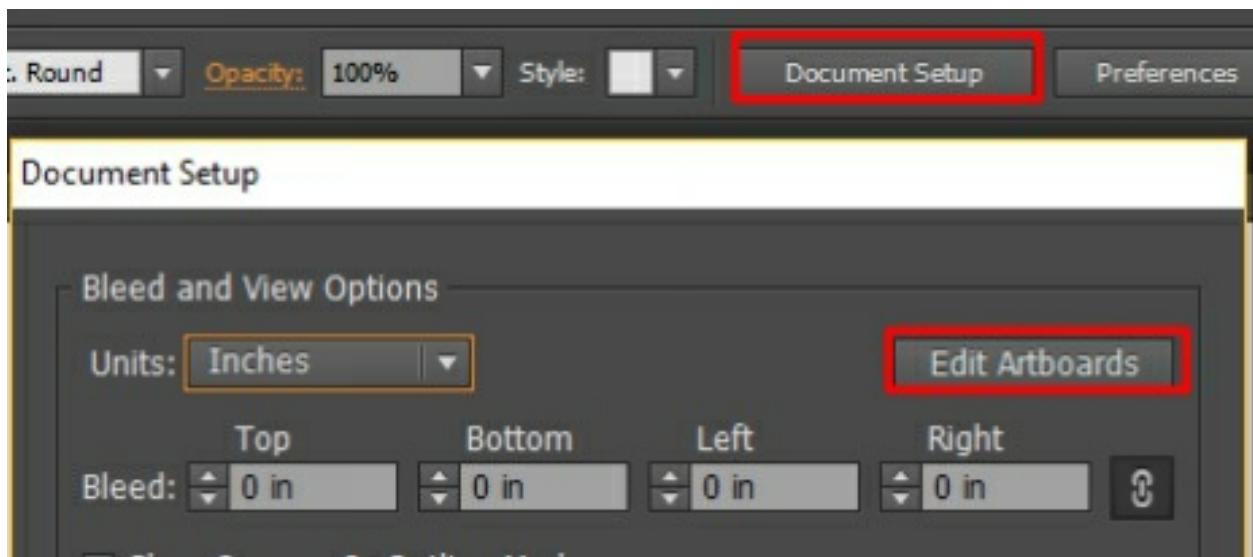
## ADDING AN ARTBOARD

- Select the Artboard instrument in the Tools board. Drag to make an Artboard. Pick an Artboard preset from the Properties board

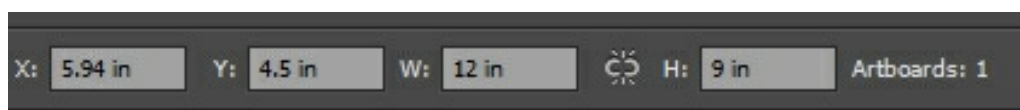
to one side of the record to resize the new Artboard. Drag the Artboard to situate it.

- To rename an Artboard, double-tap the Artboard name in the Artboards board (Window -> Artboards), change it, and afterwards, hit Enter. The Artboards panel shows you all Artboards in the archive.

## EDITING AN ARTBOARD



- Without selecting anything, click Document Setup at the Control panel and select Edit Artboards.
- Click to choose an Artboard, and pick an Artboard pre-made from the Properties board to restructure the Artboard.
- To copy an Artboard, (**Option-drag** (macOS) or **Alt-drag**(Windows) the Artboard.) Discharge the mouse catch and afterward the key.
- You can also set a size value for your Artboard at the Control panel.



## THE ARTBOARD TOOL

### ➤ The Artboard Tool (*Shift + O*)

There are numerous approaches to make another Artboard that go past opening another document. Actuating the Artboard instrument places Illustrator into Artboard altering mode. The Artboard has a bounding box, snatch handles, crop marks, and a nameplate showing up with it in the workspace when actuated. You have two or three alternatives in this mode:

- Add another Artboard by clicking and hauling the cursor anyplace outside the current Artboard. It permits you to make an Artboard of any size. On the off chance that you have to change the size, simply snap and drag any of the snatches handles to alter. It also works for any Artboard in the workspace.

### TIP

To make the Artboard bigger than the current window, drag the cursor to the edge of the screen, and it will consequently look to uncover more space.

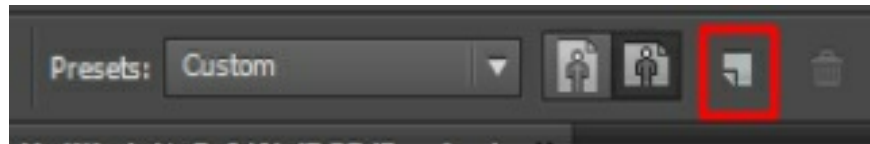
- Delete an Artboard by clicking Delete. On the off-chance that you have different Artboards to terminate, selecting Delete on different occasions will evacuate them in sliding requests until you have just one remaining.

NOTE: Artist requires in any event, one Artboard consistently. Moreover, erasing the Artboard doesn't erase the crafts on it. You can only do that manually.

## UTILIZING THE CONTROL PANEL

To utilize the Control board for Artboard altering, do these below:

1. Click the Artboard apparatus *Shift + O* to enter the Artboard altering mode.
2. Create another Artboard by tapping the New symbol, as shown below.

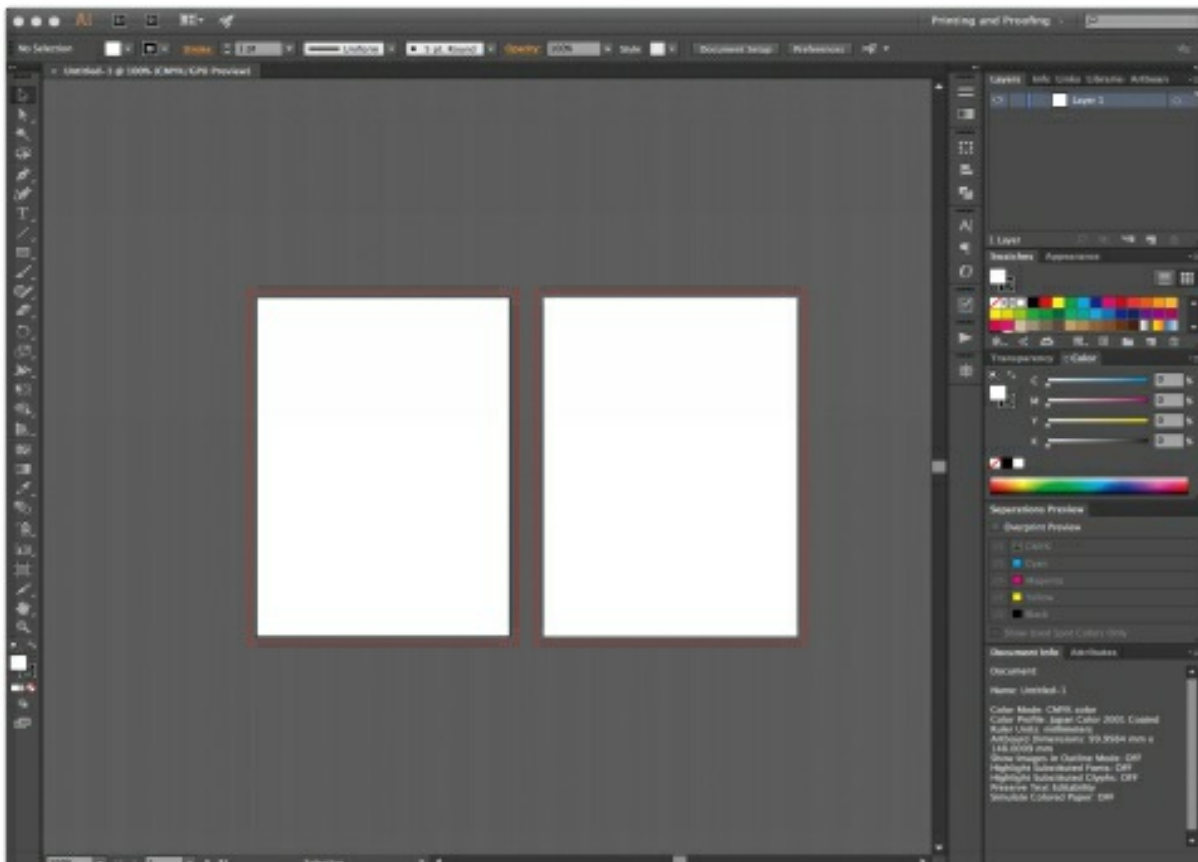


*Clicking the New symbol lets you make another Artboard.*

It permits you to put another Artboard in the workspace with a similar size and direction as the presently chosen Artboard. In the wake of tapping the New symbol, you'll notice that you have a container that follows the cursor.

Click to put another Artboard.

3. Click anyplace in the workspace to put the new Artboard in that spot.

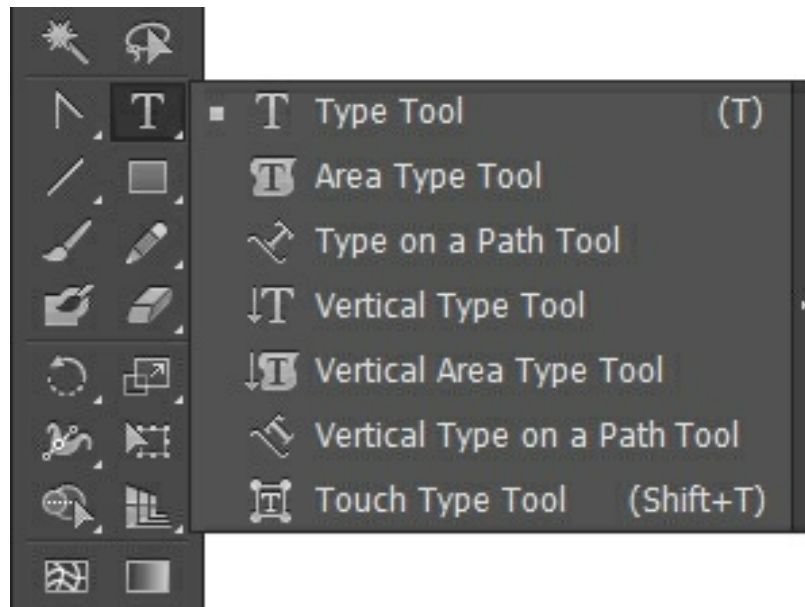


# 4.

## THE TYPE TOOL

Type is a fundamental piece of Adobe Illustrator; regardless of whether your work area is desktop publishing, structuring logos, or utilizing a model for picture building, you'll be going after the Type Tool. This chapter will cover the basics of type tool and its usefulness in adobe Illustrator.





## THE TYPE TOOL

You can easily find the Type tool on the Tools panel on your left-hand side.

Now, click on the Artboard to start a Point Text object.

We are the best

## THE AREA TYPE TOOL

Select a Closed Path to make an Area Type object.



## THE VERTICAL TYPE TOOL

Select the Artboard to start a Point Text object with vertically continuous letters.

### Vertical Area Type Tool

Select a path to create an area type text with vertically increasing letters.

### Vertical Type on a Path Tool

Select a path to create vertically continuous letters along that line.

## CREATING OUTLINES

In Adobe Illustrator, you have the freedom to convert text or letters into outlines or artwork.

Fundamentally, you can change the content into an item, so you can no longer alter that text by composing. The good news about this is that it spares you the difficulty and time of sending textual styles to every individual who needs to utilize the record.

Transforming text into diagrams causes it to seem like your content with the Pen tool. You need to utilize this apparatus while making logos that you are sure will be used repeatedly by others or work of art that you might not have power over.

If you want to convert letters or text into the outline, here is how;

1. Input any text on your page. For example, your country's name and be sure the font size is more than 36 to make sure the outline is noticeable.
2. Click on the Selection tool, right-click, and choose Create Outlines.
3. Likewise, you can utilize the shortcut **Ctrl+ Shift+ O** for Windows or **Cmd+ Shift+ O** for Mac.

To move each character in a text, use the Ungroup option in the Object tab or select Group to join the letters.

## **SUMMARY**

So far, you have learned about the type tools and how to use it in transforming letters one by one or in groups with the use of the Area Type, Touch-type, and Vertical Type Tools.

# 5.

## GETTING TO KNOW VECTOR BASICS

**I**llustrator is one of the best graphics software out there today you can use in creating vector artwork. This chapter will focus on the basics of vector and the use of selection tools.

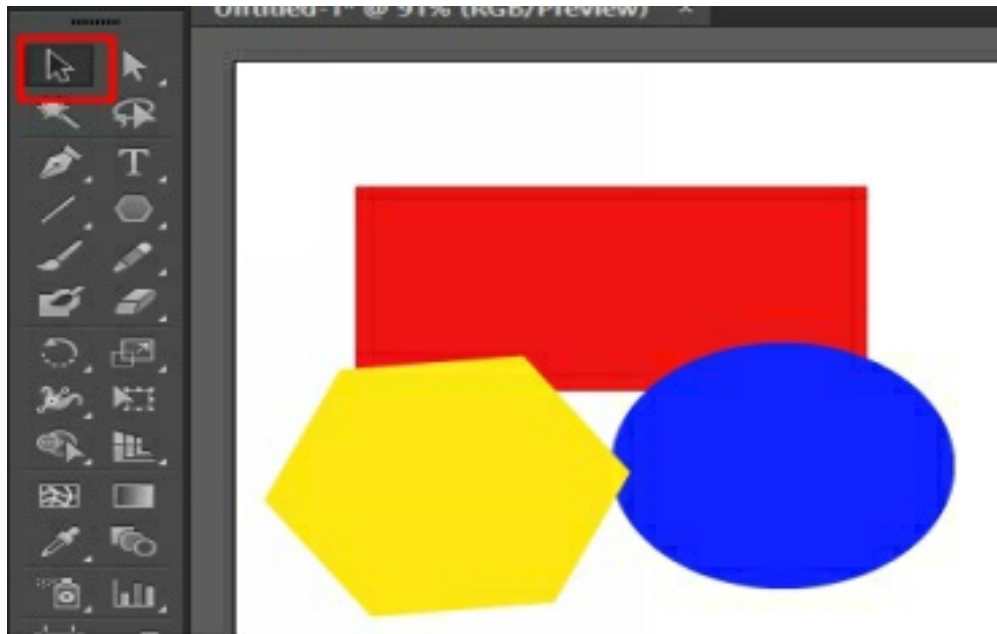
### THE VECTOR OVERVIEW

While creating your work without any preparation is continually satisfying, utilizing previously existing vector designs in your task empowers you to work more efficiently. The most significant bit of leeway to using vectors in your ventures is their adaptability. That is, you can resize a vector into small or extremely huge sizes without losing its quality. Raster pictures, for example, photos will pixelate upon growth, which makes a muddled, amateurish look.

Dissimilar to raster pictures, vectors have individual layers that might be altered or cut out. Adobe Illustrator—a program made explicitly for working with, and changing vector designs—is a significant platform for utilizing these pictures.

## THE SELECTION TOOL

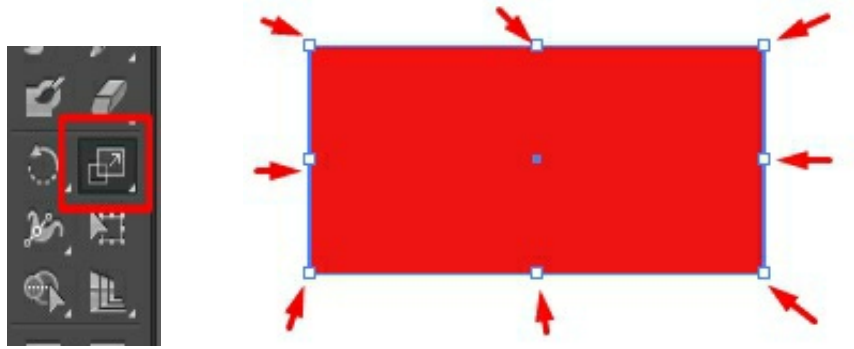
There are many selection tools in adobe illustrator, and one of them is the Selection tool.



The selection tool chooses an object or combination of it. It enables all anchor points in an object or combination of it and permitting you to move an image or object without altering its shape at the same time.

## THE SCALE TOOL

The Scale tool gives you the freedom to alter an object's size by increasing or decreasing it. To scale an object using the scale tool in Illustrator;

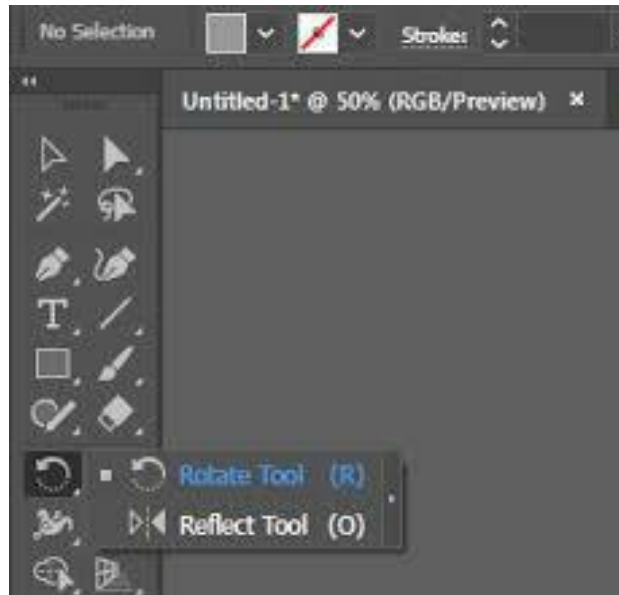


Simply select the item, and drag it to scale.

1. Pulling anyplace in the Artboard window will scale comparative with the image mid-point.
2. You can change the default reference point (the item's middle) by first clicking where you need the reference point and then pulling to scale your image.
3. Holding down the ***Shift*** key on your keyboard as you drag will keep up the item's extents as it scales.
4. Holding down ***Shift*** as you drag up and down or on a level plane, right and left, will scale the item along one axis.

## THE ROTATE TOOL

The rotate tool can turn any shape around a fixed origin.



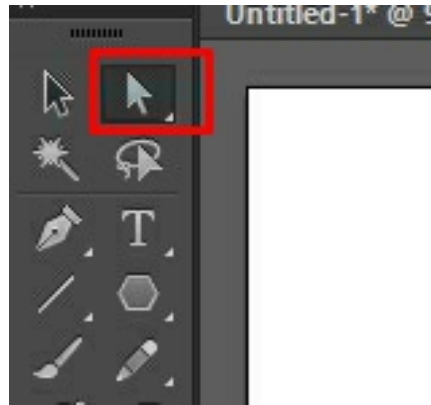
1. Highlight the object using the selection tool

From the toolbar, pick the rotation tool

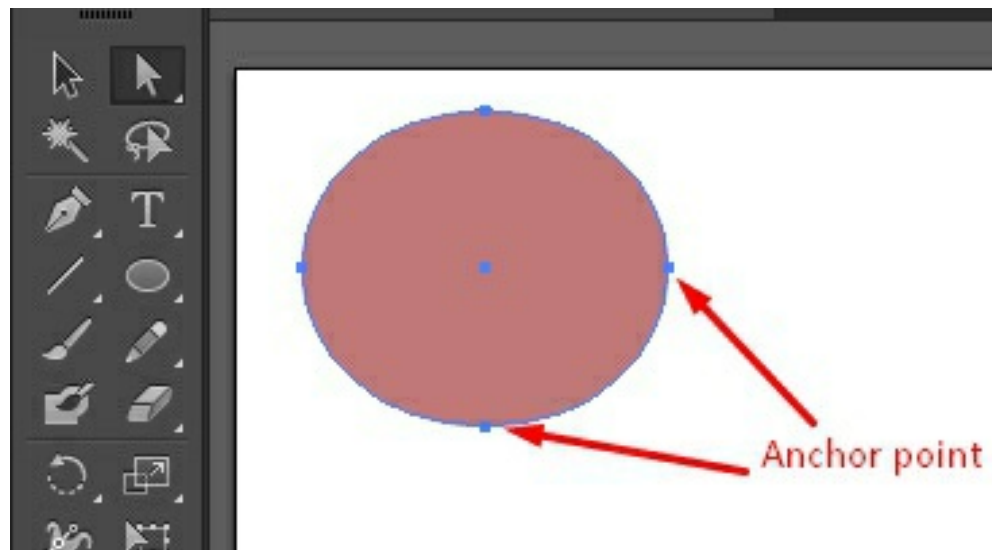
2. To turn the object around its mid-point, haul in a round movement anyplace in the new document window.
3. To spin the shape around another point of origin, which is a substitute, click once, anyplace on your Artboard window to reposition the center point.
4. To spin a copy of your shape, hold down the **Alt** key on your keyboard.

## THE DIRECT SELECTION TOOL

The Direct Selection tool permits you to choose and alter paths inside shapes. With the direct selection tool, click on one of the objects, you will see that it doesn't select the whole object like the selection tool but instead picks only the object you click. You can choose, hold, and drag to move the shape. Progressively helpful, however, is the capacity to alter the object's paths.



You will see that the object has a blue hover around it with four blue squares. Drift more than one of the squares, and you will see the symbol change. These squares are known as anchor points. You can pick and hold the anchor points and move them around if you want. When you have tapped on the anchor point, you will likewise observe lines getting over it. These are known as direction points.



## THE ANCHOR POINTS

It is at the edge of an object's paths, and anchor points give graphics artists control over where the object's trajectory is going. There are two sorts of anchor points: corner points and smooth points.

1. Corner points can join straight lines, curved lines, or a blend of



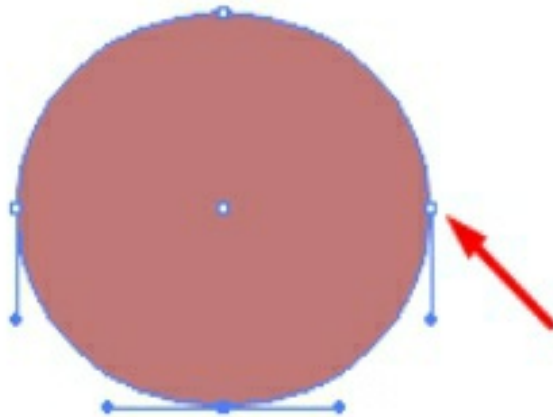
the two. However, in all cases, the end exists with the goal that the path can alter course.

2. Smooth points, on the other hand, are planned in such a way that it proceeds as one continuous line, with no unforeseen alters in course or arch.

## THE ANCHOR HANDLES

The Anchor handles are little squares on the paths that give you the freedom to control how firmly or freely you can twist the bend at every one of them. Anchor handles are digression lines that permit you to alter the course of the path arch.

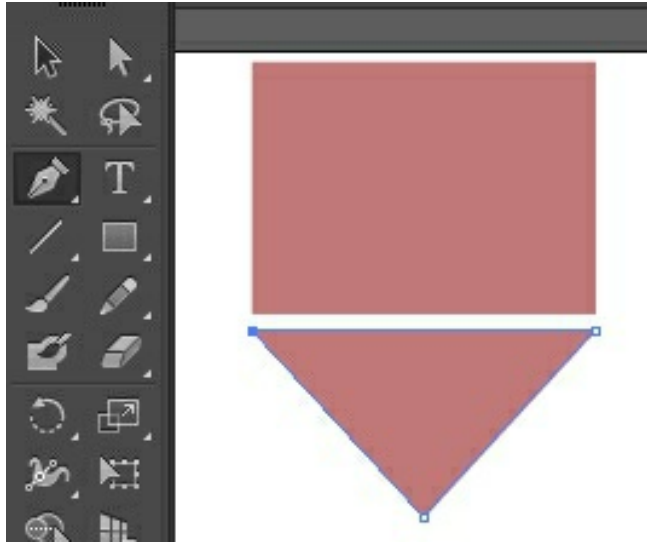
Double click on an anchor point to see the anchor handles.



## ADDING ANCHOR POINTS

You might decide to add more items to your shape or, perhaps, draw on your shape.

- Select the Pen tool in the toolbar and click over the area you want the anchor point.
- You should be careful while doing this in order not to remove an anchor point while trying to add another.

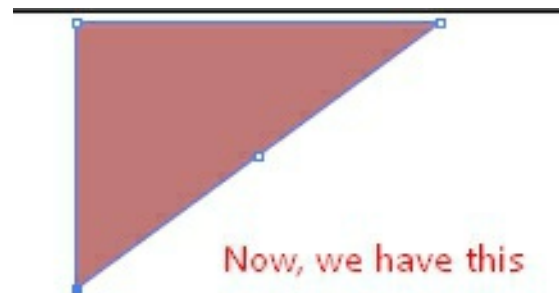
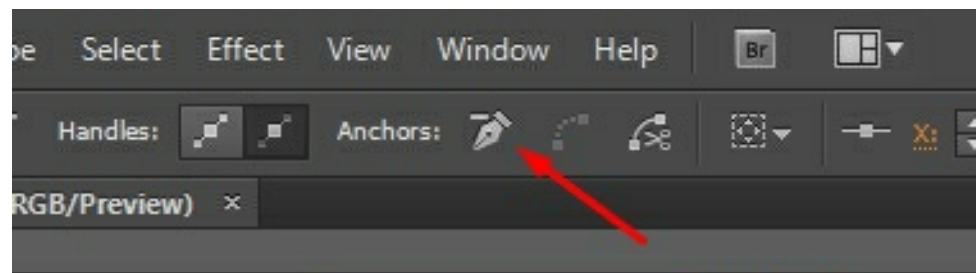


## DELETING ANCHOR POINTS

While you might no longer need Anchor Points for your work, you can by doing the following;



- Select the Pen tool in the toolbar and click over the anchor point.
- Or select the point with the Direct Selection tool
- Finally, click on the Remove selected anchor points at the control panel to remove your desired points.

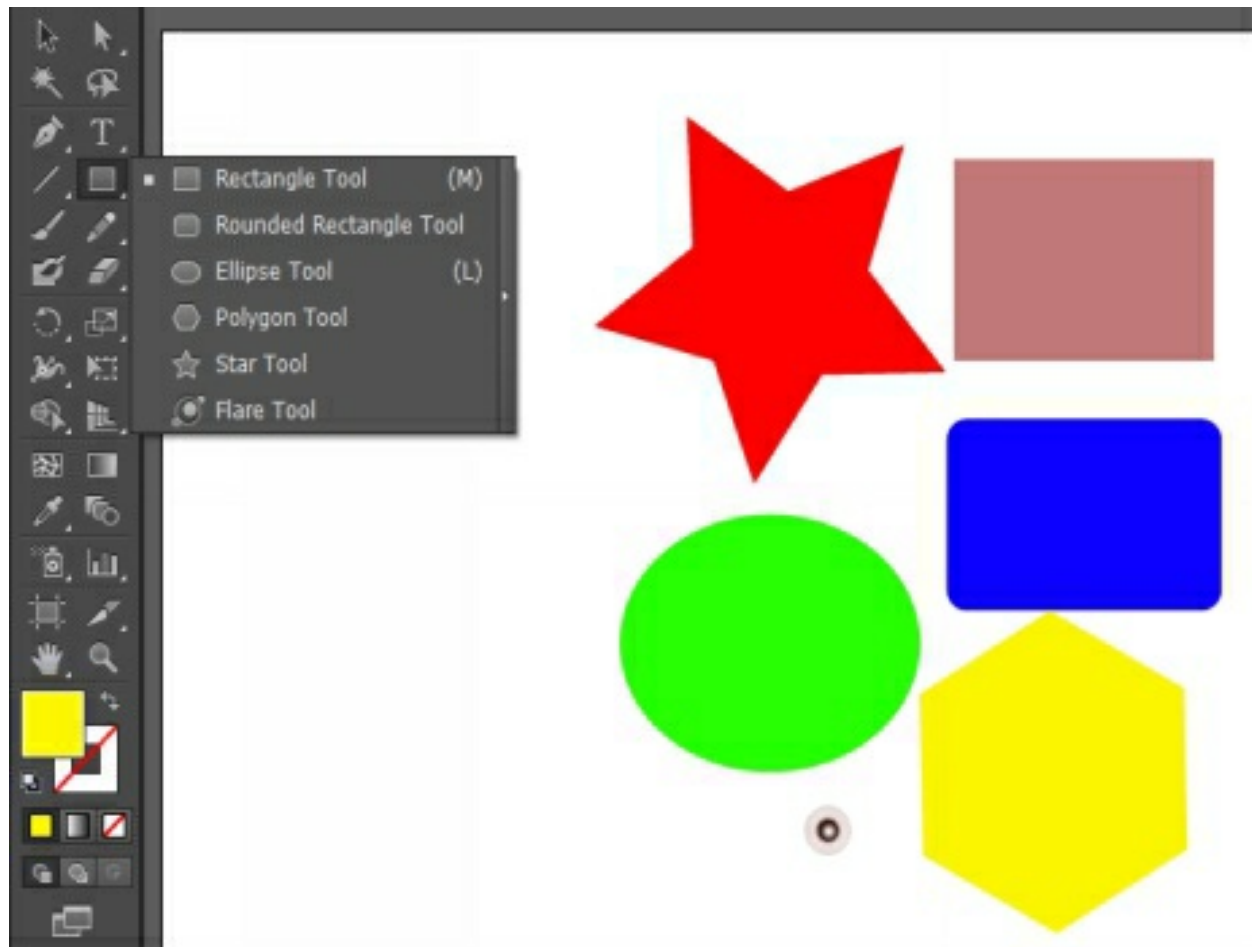


Now, we have this

## **6.**

# **CREATING VECTOR SHAPES**

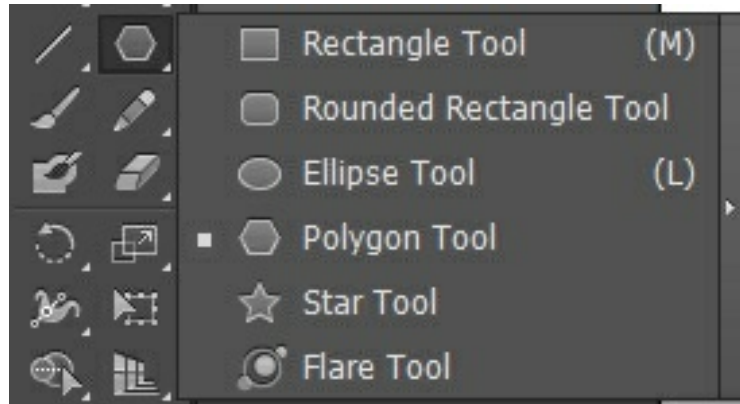
**S**hape Vectors are essential features in your Illustrator, as it helps you to create numerous simple shapes.



1. To create the shape vector you desire, long click on the shape tool to see the different shapes in the library.
2. Click on the rectangle tool icon and then click over the Illustrator canvas.
3. Set the settings as indicated on the accompanying illustration, or you can also set your size and ensure that you make the size equal on both sides.
4. The next step is to use the Rounded Rectangle Tool to create a rounded square by doing the same thing as the previous step.
5. To make the process easy, add a setting for its corner radius because the Rounded Rectangle Tool has round corners.
6. There are several options for other shapes, such as the Ellipse, Hexagon, and so on. You can also add colors to your vector shapes.

## THE RECTANGULAR SHAPE TOOL

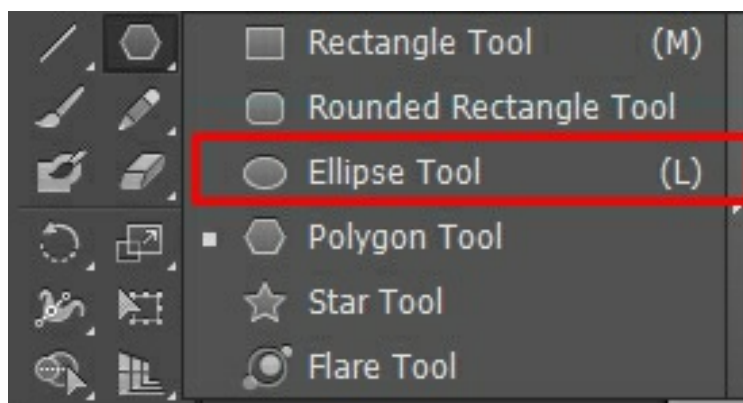
Does it interest you to know why the rectangular shape tool is Important to the Illustrator, it is because all your desired shape tools are hidden in it.



1. You can access this if you press and hold the rectangle tool; you would see various options such as the Rectangle tool, Ellipse tool, Star tool, Polygon tool, and Line segment tool.
2. You can now use these numerous options to create a variety of shapes you desire for your artworks.

## THE ELLIPSE SHAPE TOOL

During your design, you might desire to draw ovals, circles, or ellipses. The Ellipse Shape tool is a great way to go.



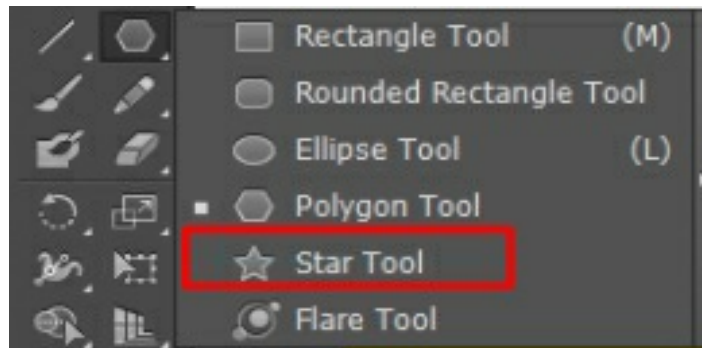
1. You can start by pressing and holding the rectangular shape tool

in the tool options.

2. Several tools appear and then click on the Ellipse tool.
3. You can now use your Ellipse tool to create circular-shaped arts or Ellipses.

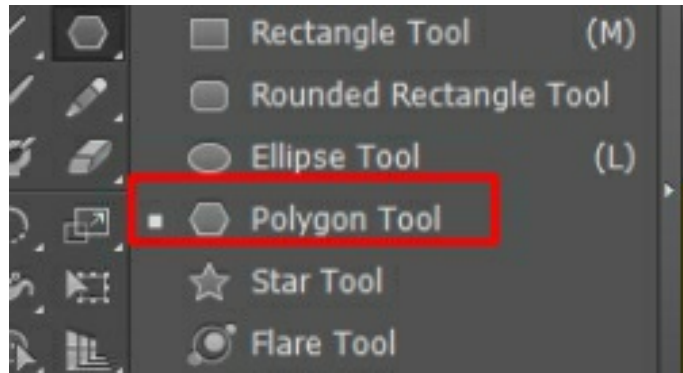
## THE STAR SHAPE TOOL

In case you have a design that requires star shapes, the star Shape Tool is a great way to make your artwork come into reality. For this to work effectively, you need a few keyboard modifiers to get the required number of points or increase or decrease the star's radius.



1. You can start by pressing the Up and Down Arrow to get the star points removed or added as you draw it in the Artboard.
2. To straighten your star shape, you can use the Shift button.
3. You can also hold down the **Ctrl** (Windows) or **Command** (Mac OS) and drag to change the star's arms or reduce or increase the star radius.

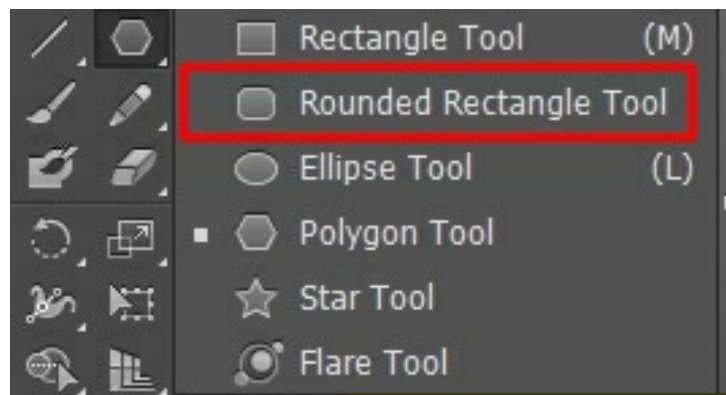
## THE POLYGON SHAPE TOOL



1. To use the Polygon shape tool, select and hold the rectangle shape tool.
2. Click on the Polygon tool in the toolbox option.
3. Drag the arc to rotate the polygon until it is at the desired size.
4. You can also use the Up and Down Arrow keys to add or reduce the polygon's sides.
5. You might also desire to work on where you want the center of the polygon to be. All you need is to specify a radius and several sides for the polygon.
6. Click on the OK button to activate it.

## THE ROUNDED RECTANGULAR SHAPE TOOL

If you have an art that requires you to form or create rounded rectangles with round corners;



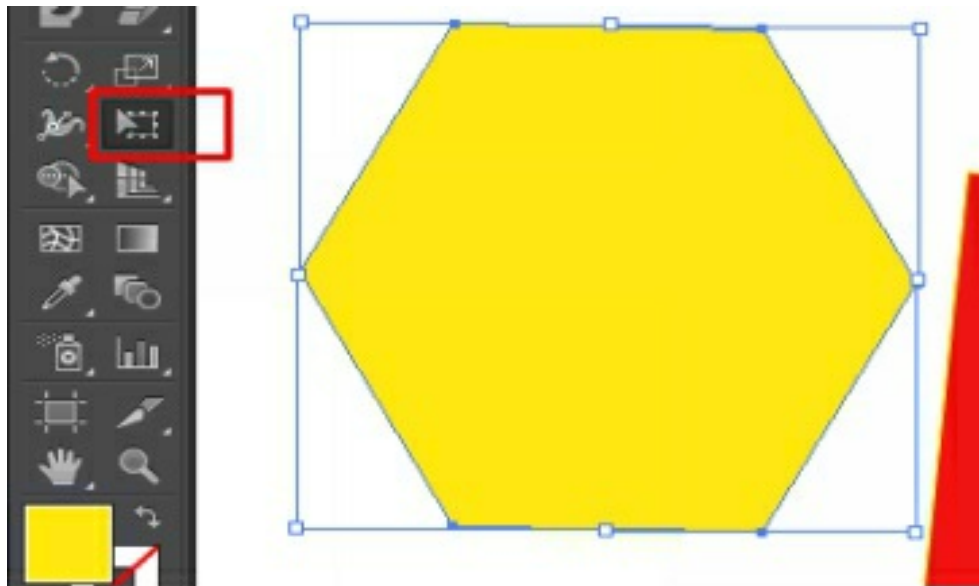
1. Go to the toolbar and select the Rectangular Shape Tool.



2. A drop-down appears on the window, then click on the option of the rounded rectangular shape tool.
3. Hold the Up/Down Arrow key to change the corner faster if desired.
4. Then click on the Artboard to set the desired size in the Rounded Rectangle Option box.

## THE FREE TRANSFORM TOOL

The free transform tool enables you to move and reorganize your artwork.



1. Firstly, select the artwork on the Artboard.
2. Click on the Free Transform Tool on the Tool panel.
3. Drag a corner handle on the bounding box.
4. Stop the drag at the desired level of distortion.

# 7.

## GROUPING VECTOR SHAPES

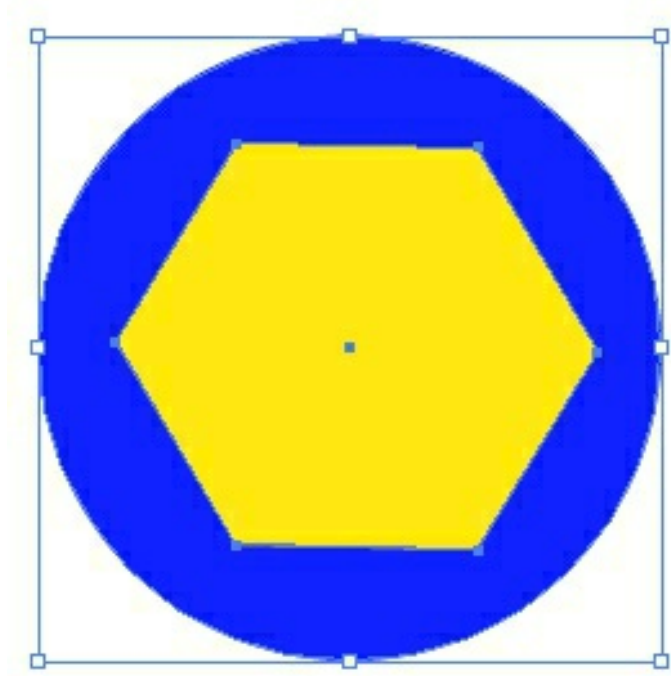
### ARRANGING OBJECTS

While creating unique artwork, you may wish to align, distribute or even duplicate an object(s), and for you to be able to arrange your object in the Artboard properly;

1. Start by selecting the arts you wish to work on.
2. Click on the Edit tab to choose from the drop-down options.
3. You can choose the cut ***Ctrl or Cmd + X*** option to move the art or copy ***Ctrl or Cmd + C*** to duplicate it.
4. Once you have moved your artwork to your desired location, which could be in front, back, center, or on all the Artboards, simply click on the paste button.

### GROUPING VECTORS

There are times when you may need to join two or more objects to seem as though it is a single entity. For example, you might decide to put a polygon in a circle with this feature.

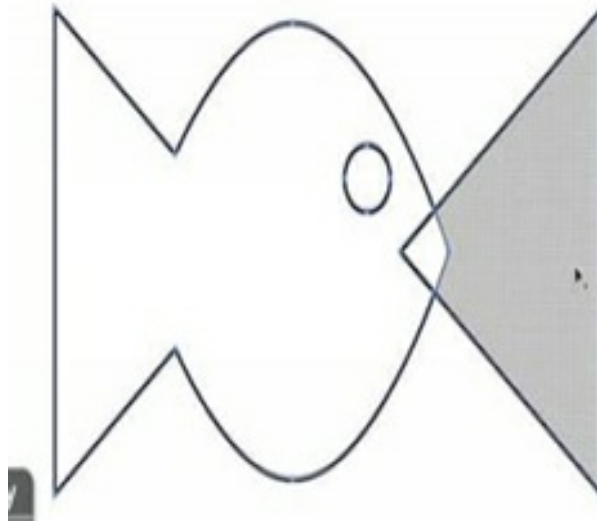
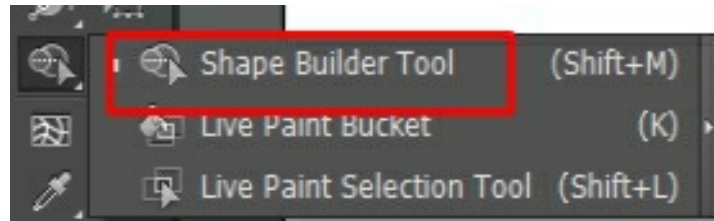


To do this, you would need to:

1. Arrange the objects
2. Select the objects you want to group with the Selection tool.
3. Click on the Object tab and choose Group.

## **THE SHAPE BUILDER TOOL**

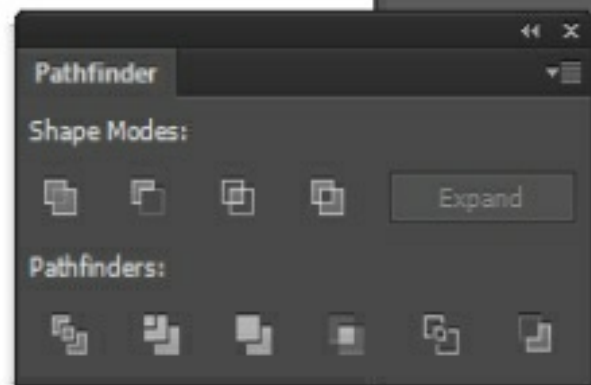
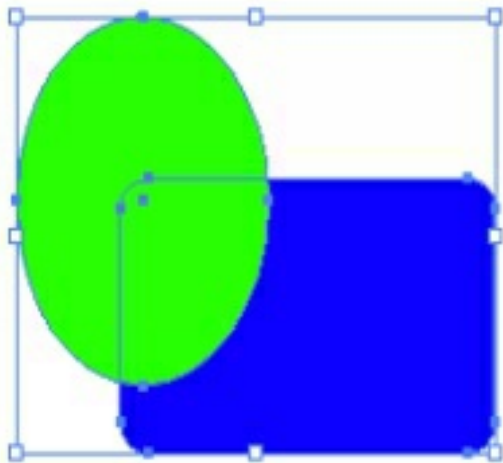
If you wish to merge or combine different paths for your artwork, one of the best ways to achieve this is to use the shape builder tool in the tool panel. It can also help you to add extra or breakpoints in the artwork.



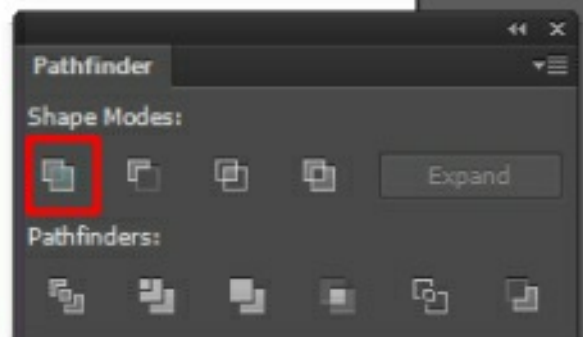
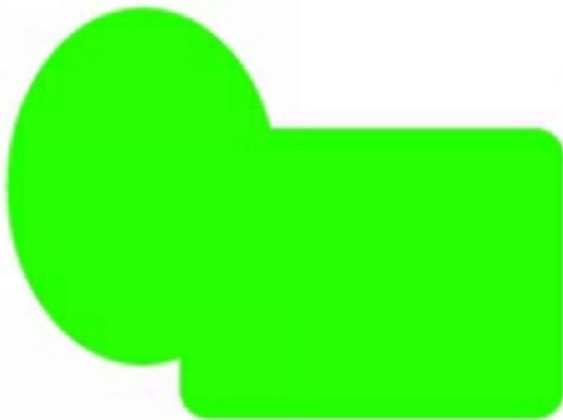
- You can combine shapes and merge objects; with this feature, you use it to remove forms, and so on.
- The shape builder tool also has an erase mode with which you can delete regions in your artwork. These regions can be within the desired shape selected. You can also use the erase mode for removing edges if necessary.

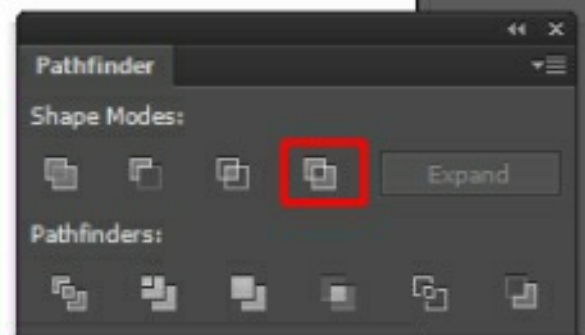
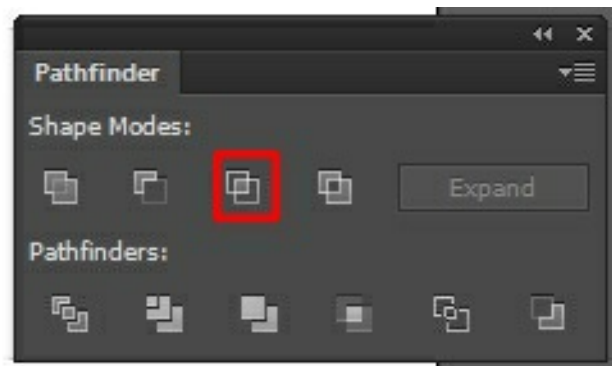
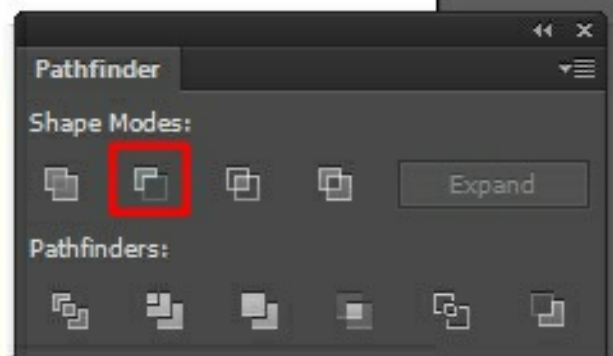
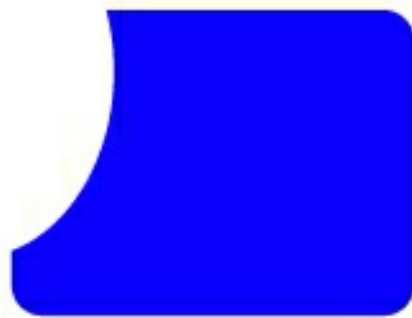
## **CUTTING SHAPES OUT OF VECTOR**

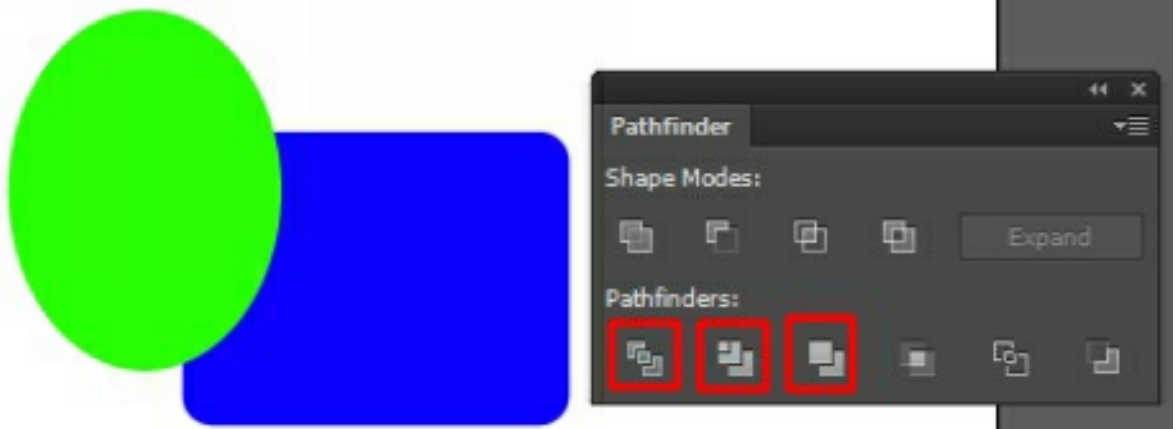
Do you wish to know how to trim out different shapes out of a vector image? These tips are useful to you! It may be necessary for your artwork to have a cutout of another way, as this would make the design more unique. To do this, you just have to follow these easy steps:



1. From the Tool panel, you can select both arts by using the Selection tool.
2. From the Window tab, click on the Pathfinder option ***Shift + Ctrl + F9.***
3. The options appear after a click on the Pathfinder tool.
4. Click on each of the options to discover how they work.
5. The vector would now have a cutout of the previously selected shape.







All these options allow you to add, multiply, or reduce your strokes and make a meaningful design on your Artboard. Explore more to discover how well you can make use of these options.

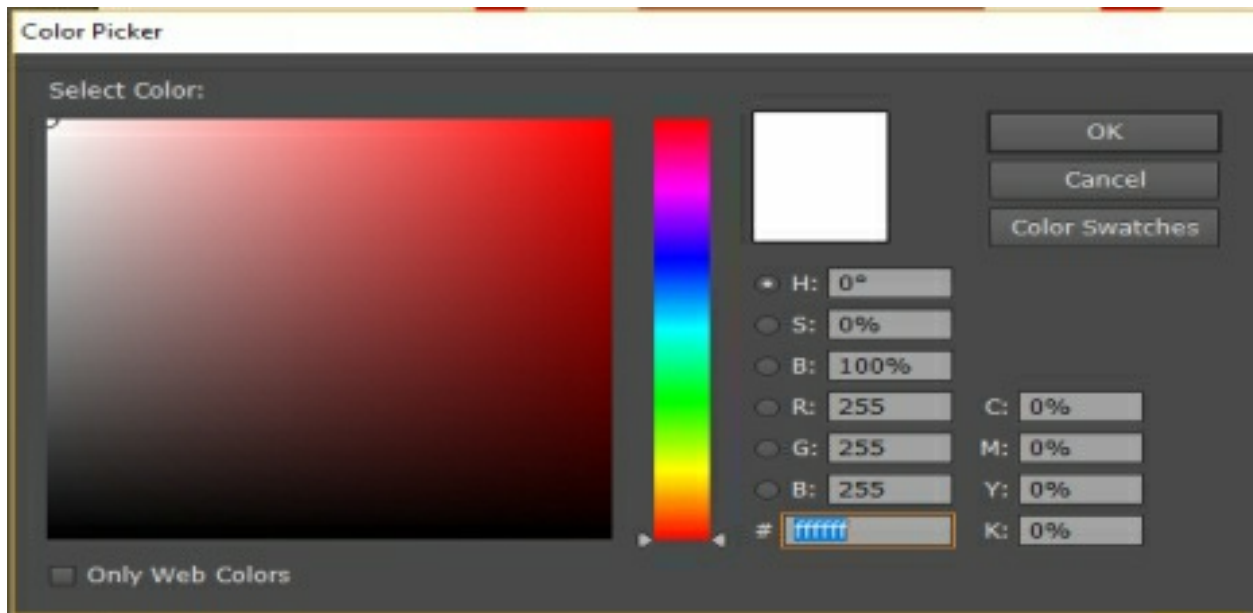
## 8.

# THE FILL AND STROKE EFFECTS

A fill is a shading encased by a path. A stroke is a line of shading that exactly follows a path. Albeit a stroke can be any thickness that generally utilizes away as its mid-point. You can adapt your strokes with intense hues or patterns, however, not with gradients. This chapter will focus on the fill effects, stroke effects, stroke align effects, stroke dash effect, and arrowhead effects.







## THE FILL EFFECTS

The fill effects help you to add color to the inner part of your object.

1. Select your object with the Selection tool.
2. Double click the Fill option in the Tools panel.
3. Pick a color from the color picker; you also have the option to input a color code. Then, click Ok.

## THE STROKE EFFECTS

You can apply stroke effects to a whole object, or you can utilize the Live Paint group and apply various strokes to various edges inside the shape.

1. Select the item.
2. Then, decide whether to choose either the Color menu, Control menu, or the stroke icon. Doing so shows that you need to apply a stroke as opposed to a fill.
3. Decide between choosing a color or a pattern from the Swatches board or the Control panel. Click on the Stroke icon twice to pick

a color.

4. Choose a weight value.
5. Assuming the object happens to be a closed path, pick a choice from the Stroke tool menu to adjust the stroke path.



## THE STROKE ALIGN EFFECTS

For a closed shape, you can pick from the stroke panel to align the stroke. Stroke alignment is of three types

- You can align to the mid-point or center
- You can align to the Inside, and
- You can align to the outside

If you want to align different stroke alignment paths, there is a good chance it won't work. To avoid this, ensure the stroke alignment path settings share the same values, especially if you want an end to end alignment.

## THE STROKE CORNER EFFECTS

You can choose at least one corner anchor point in a straight path or various anchor points over a few ways in your design. In the end, when selected, a Live Corners icon shows up close to each corner.

Here is how to use the live corner widget;

1. With your design open, utilizing the Direct Selection Tool naturally chooses all the Live Corner widgets. Be that as it may, you can select at least one explicit corner.
2. To choose one corner, click on the Live Corner widget.
3. To choose explicit corners, press Shift and tap the Live Corner widgets you need to choose.
4. To de-select, a chosen corner, press Shift, and tap the particular Live Corner widget.
5. Select the Corners to interface in the Control Panel or the Properties board, and set the choices accessible.
6. Double-tap the Live Corners widget, and afterward adjust the choices in the Corners dialog.

## **THE STROKE DASH EFFECTS**

You can make a dabbed or dotted line by altering a shape's stroke qualities.

1. Select the shape
2. While your cursor is still on the Stroke tool, choose Dashed Line. And if peradventure the Dashed Line alternative isn't in the menu, click on the Stroke menu.
3. Pick the tool. This tool gives you the freedom to make the runs at the corners and edges of the paths steady and unsurprising.

## **THE ARROWHEAD EFFECTS**

You can get to arrowheads from the Stroke board and associate controls to alter the size. Utilizing the Stroke window, you can likewise effectively trade

arrowheads.

You can also alter the edge of the arrowheads freely with Scale alternatives. The alternatives are:

- Expand arrow tip past edge of a path
- Point arrow tip to the edge of the path.

# 9.

## WORKING WITH COLOURS

This chapter will focus based on using colors and color swatches in Adobe Illustrator. It also includes information on creating shade for artwork, using Pantones and Gradients, picking colors from an existing image on the Artboard, and using Transparency to enhance the visibility of your artworks.

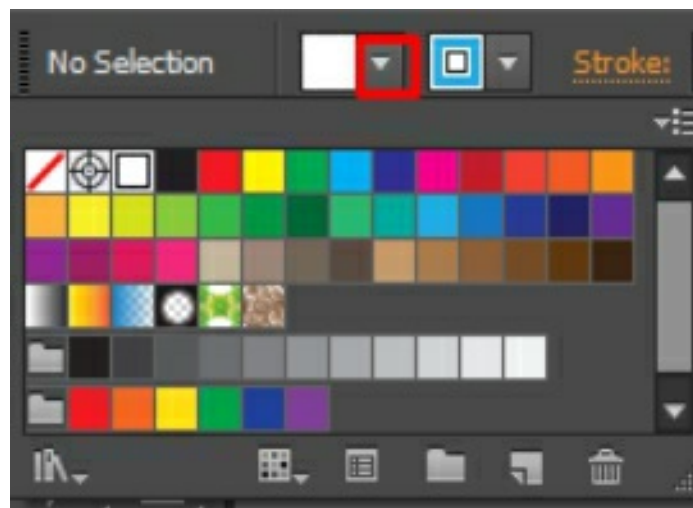
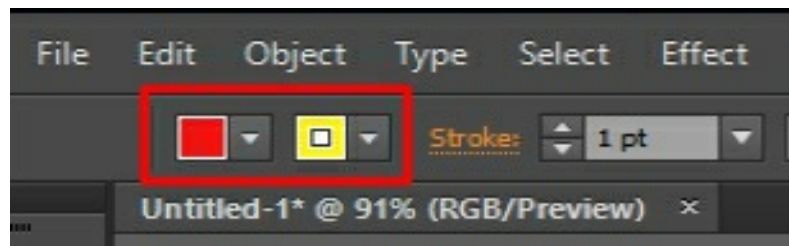
Artwork in Illustrator can be either a stroke or a fill. The fill or the stroke can be in the form of a gradient, color, or other patterns—all these tools you can use for designing the artwork. The following illustrates how to use the colors, swatches, gradients, etc. using the Adobe Illustrator.

### USING COLORS

Are you willing to make fresh and beautiful artwork with the Adobe Illustrator? Then, the use of color is essential for beautiful artworks. While

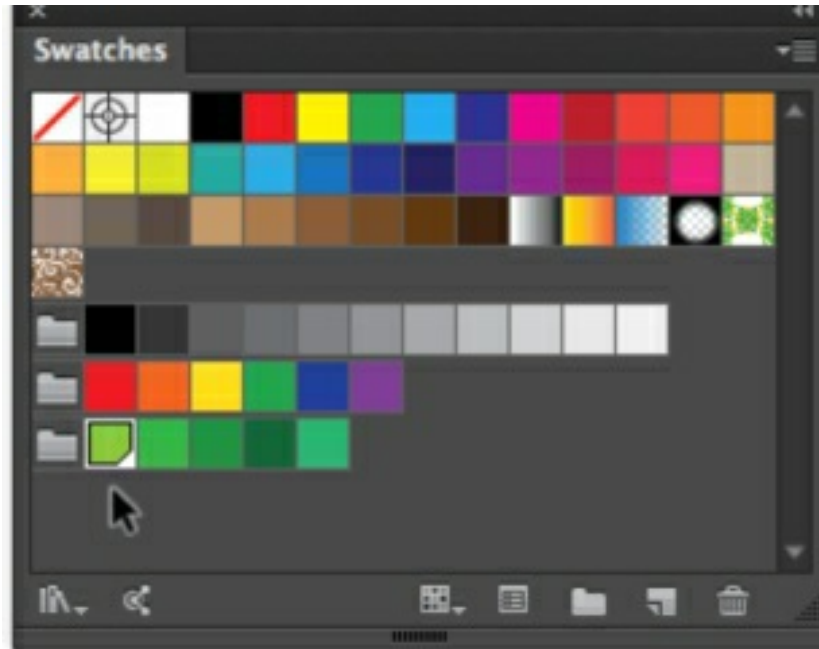
artwork without the right color can be a great turn off, learning the usage can be a great way to set out a beautiful artwork. The following tips outline how to use colors on Adobe Illustrator;

1. Go to the Control panel and find the Stroke or Fill color option.
2. Click any of these two boxes to reveal the default swatches in the document library.
3. Finally, use the color picker to create a visually appealing color by choosing from the color library.



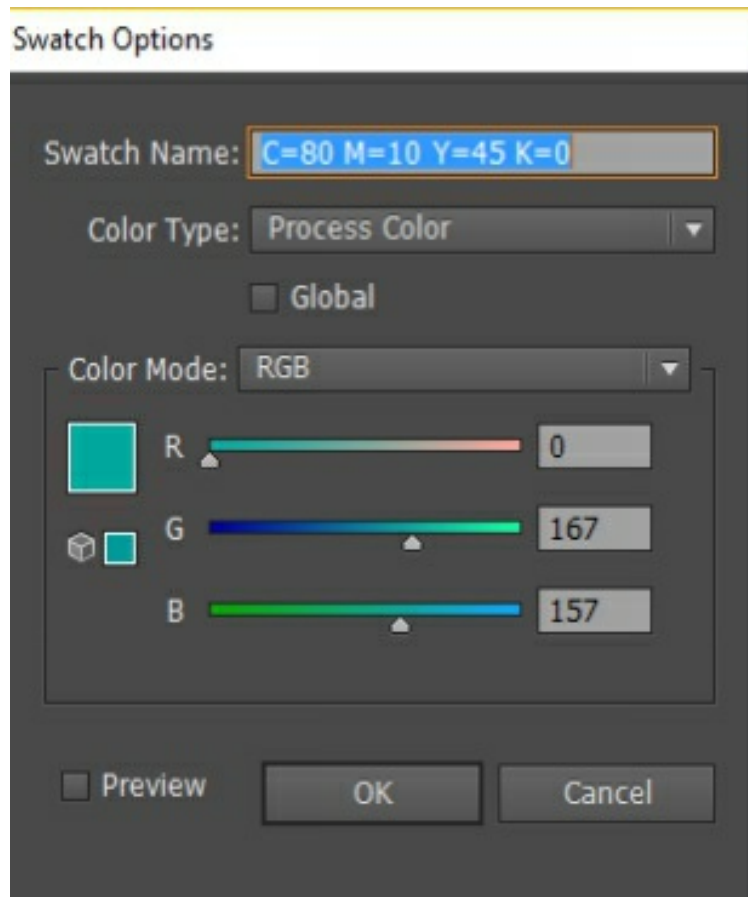
## CREATING COLOR SWATCHES

Using color swatches is essential if you wish to know how to combine different colors and try different color blends without any fear.



To know more about how to create color swatches, the following explains it;

1. With artwork on the Artboard, save the already entered custom colors as swatches.
2. Select the swatches options in the drop-down to reveal the default swatches in the document.
3. Upon selecting the swatches options, a new swatch option appears at the bottom of the panel.
4. Click on the new swatch section, and name the color as desired.
5. Set options as desired to save the color as a swatch.
6. Select the artwork on the Artboard to apply the new swatch.

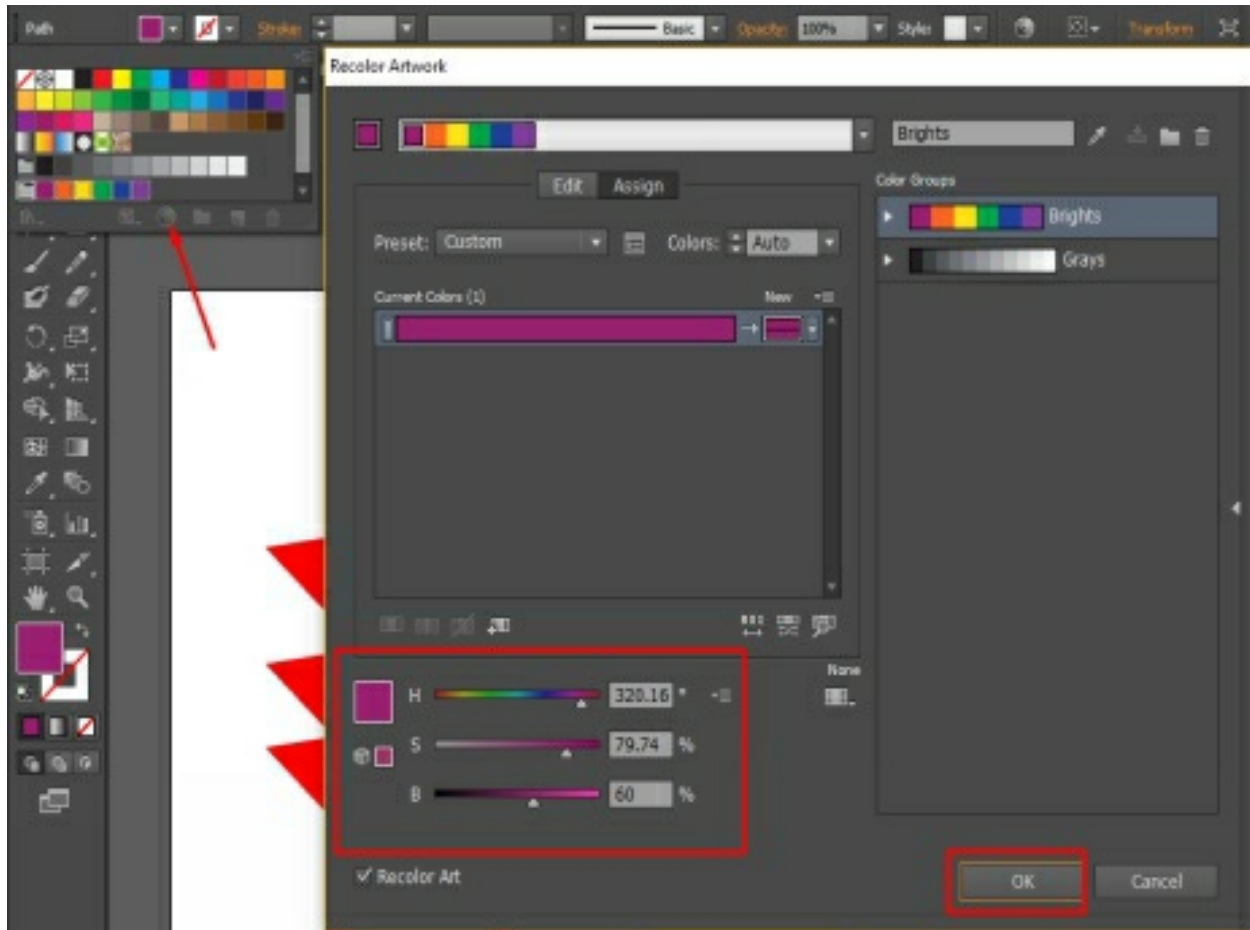


## USING PANTONE

The use of the Pantone allows the matching of color to ensure consistency of colors of artworks.

Here is how to make use of Pantone colors;





1. From the Artboard, select the artwork to receive the process colors.
2. After selecting the artwork, go to the Edit tab -> Edit Colors -> Recolor Artwork.
3. From the color options, choose your desired Pantone type color book, and click on OK on the screen.
4. New Pantone swatches become available, and the system assigns it to the artwork on the Artboard.

## PICKING COLORS FROM AN IMAGE

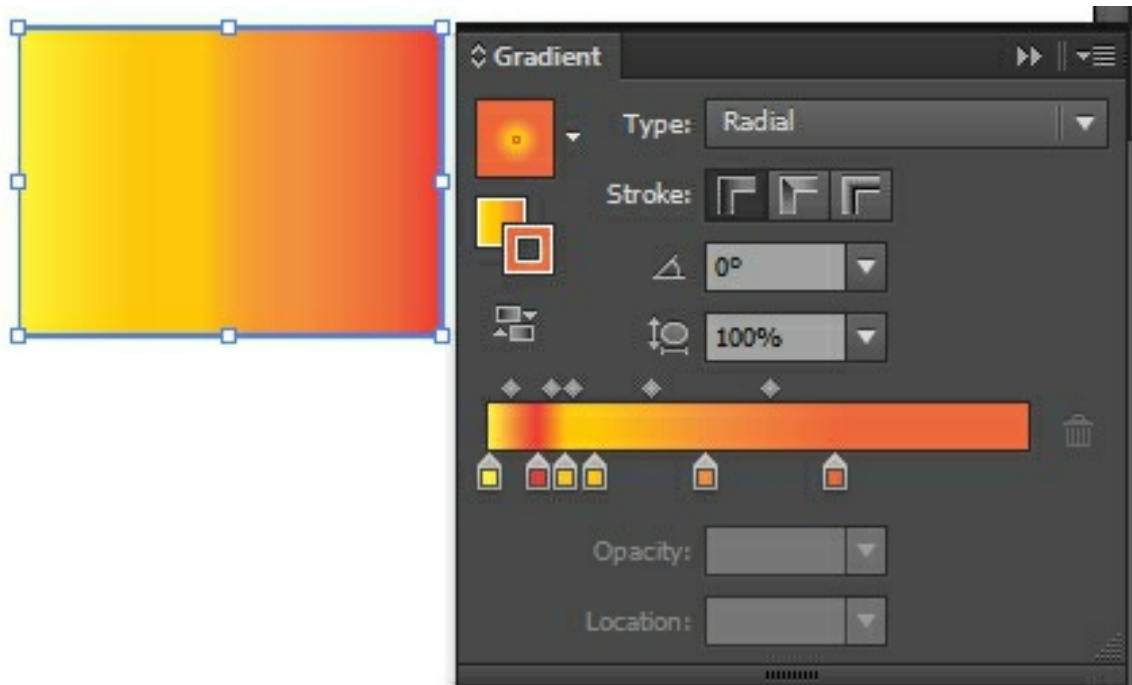
It is interesting to note that the use of color picker allows you to pick real-time colors of the artwork in your graphic illustration. The following explains how to choose colors;

1. Have your desired artwork to appear in your work area ready.
2. Create an object like a rectangular box that will accept the color.
3. Select the newly created object.
4. Click the Eyedropper tool on the Tool panel, and the eyedropper tool symbol appears.
5. Now, click on any part of the artwork area using the Eyedropper tool. The Eyedropper tool automatically fills in the color selected from the artwork on the new object.

## USING GRADIENTS

Knowing how to use gradients will avail you the 'how' to work around color blends for more visual effects. Interestingly, angles can come in three types;

- **Linear gradient:** This is simply a straight line blend of colors
- **Radial gradient:** This entails circular patterned combinations of colors
- **Freeform:** You can use points and lines to achieve this. Also, it allows a natural, smooth blend of colors.

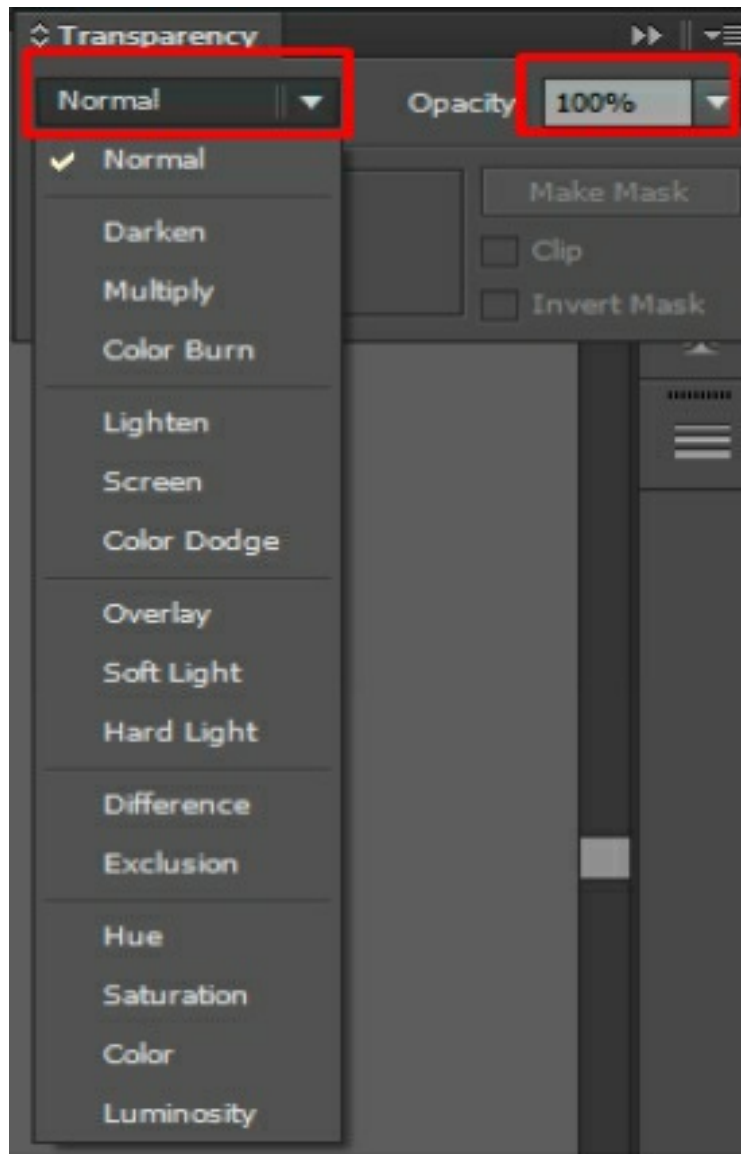


Here are easy tips on how to make use of the gradient

- Double click on the Gradient tool from the Tool panel.
- A dialogue appears, which indicates the Gradient panel. The Gradient panel shows numerous gradient options.
- Select the gradient option from the gradient panel shown
- Choose colors and Select the gradient to apply as desired.

## **USING TRANSPARENCY**

You can add Transparency to your artworks using any of the following;



- Lowering the opacity of your unnoticed artwork to become more pronounced
- Achieving disparity in Transparency by using opacity mask
- Using the blends to change colors among overlapped artworks
- Adopting shadows or other visual effects that add Transparency to artworks

To know how to make use of the Transparency tools entirely, you have to follow these steps involved;

- With artwork on the Artboard, select the Transparency option

from the window.

- A dialogue box appears in the window.
- Click on the opacity button to reduce the percentage of opacity.
- Click on the screen to see the changes.

# **10.**

## **VALUABLE INSIGHTS YOU SHOULD KNOW**

**S**ome essential insights are essential for Adobe Illustrator, which makes work navigation easy on the Illustrator. These insights involve using critical features such as zooming in and out, how to navigate, duplicate objects, and how to use rulers and guides. It also entails using smart guides for our artwork and how to scale strokes and create effects.

To better understand how to go about the use of these features, revert to the following subheadings below;

### **ZOOMING IN AND OUT**

Zooming in or out Illustrator allows you to magnify or reduce your artworks as desired. The following illustrates how to zoom in or out;

1. From the Tool panel, select the zoom tool. Once you select the zoom tool, a magnifying glass appears on the screen.



2. Select the desired area or portion of the artwork you want to magnify
3. In case you want to reduce, hold down the Alt key and click on the portion of the artwork you want to reduce
4. Choose your desired View and set the zoom level in the navigation panel below.



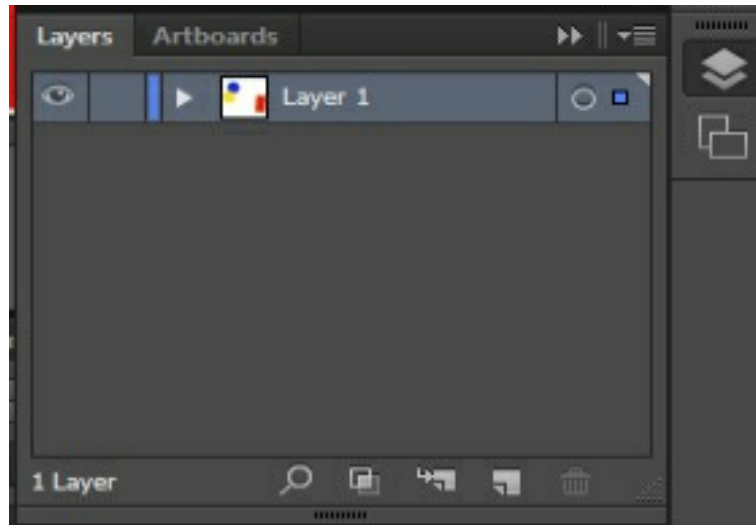
## MANEUVERING IN ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR

As an Illustrator, you need to know how to move from one point to another on the Artboard. The following ways are ways you can play around in Illustrator.

**Layers:** One of the very first steps in playing around the Artboard is to know how to make use of the layers. Here is where all the arts are stored. Therefore, it is necessary to understand how to navigate your way through. You can quickly get to the layer panel by clicking the F7 button on your keyboard.

You can quickly turn off your layer visibility by merely clicking the eye on

the Layer panel.



**Pan around:** Panning around your windows is another way to maneuver in the Illustrator. It is a simple hand tool, which is available in the Tools panel. You can click and navigate your way around your artwork.



## DUPLICATING OBJECTS

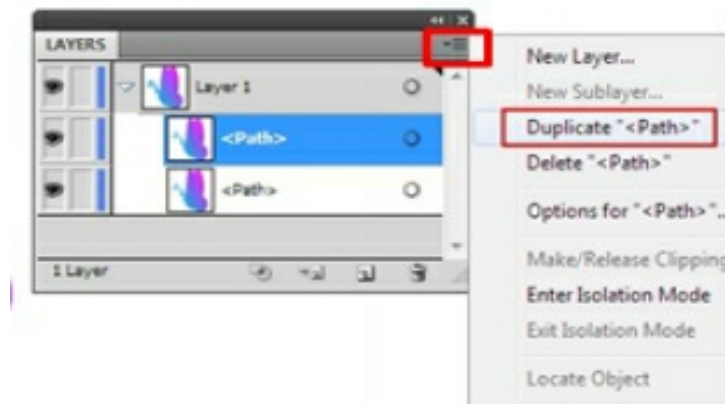
When working with artwork, you might need to make duplicates of arts for some needs as the case may be. One way to have your art posited in one or more places in the window is to know how to duplicate. You can quickly learn how to copy by mastering the following steps;

1. You can start by selecting the artwork you want to copy. Then,



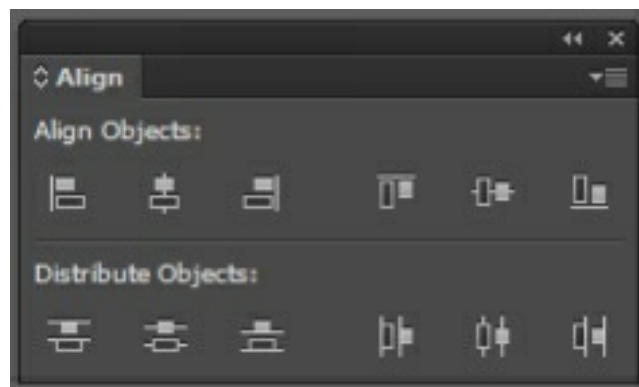
click on the Layer panel.

2. Click the drop-down icon, and then click on the option telling you to duplicate your art.
3. A duplicate button drop-down appears, click on the button to set on the duplication process.
4. Or press the **Alt-hold** and drag the artwork to your desired position.



## ALIGNING IN ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR

For you to properly align your artworks, you should follow;



1. Firstly, you have to select your artworks; select two or more artworks.
2. Open the Align panel; go to the Window tab and choose Align.
3. Make use of the Align tools to start aligning your artworks. You

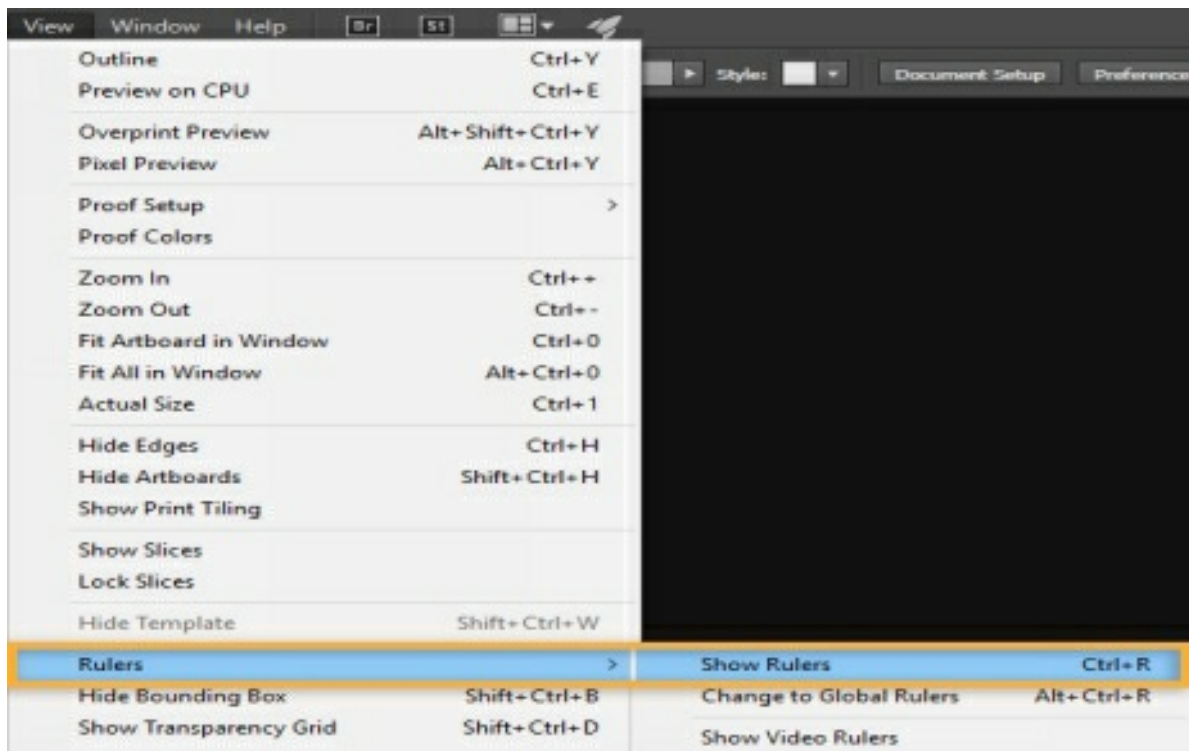
can align both vertically and horizontally by clicking the horizontal and vertical Align tools.

## USING RULERS AND GUIDES

Rulers in Illustrator are essential for the accuracy of the measure of artworks. It has a point 0 called the origin.

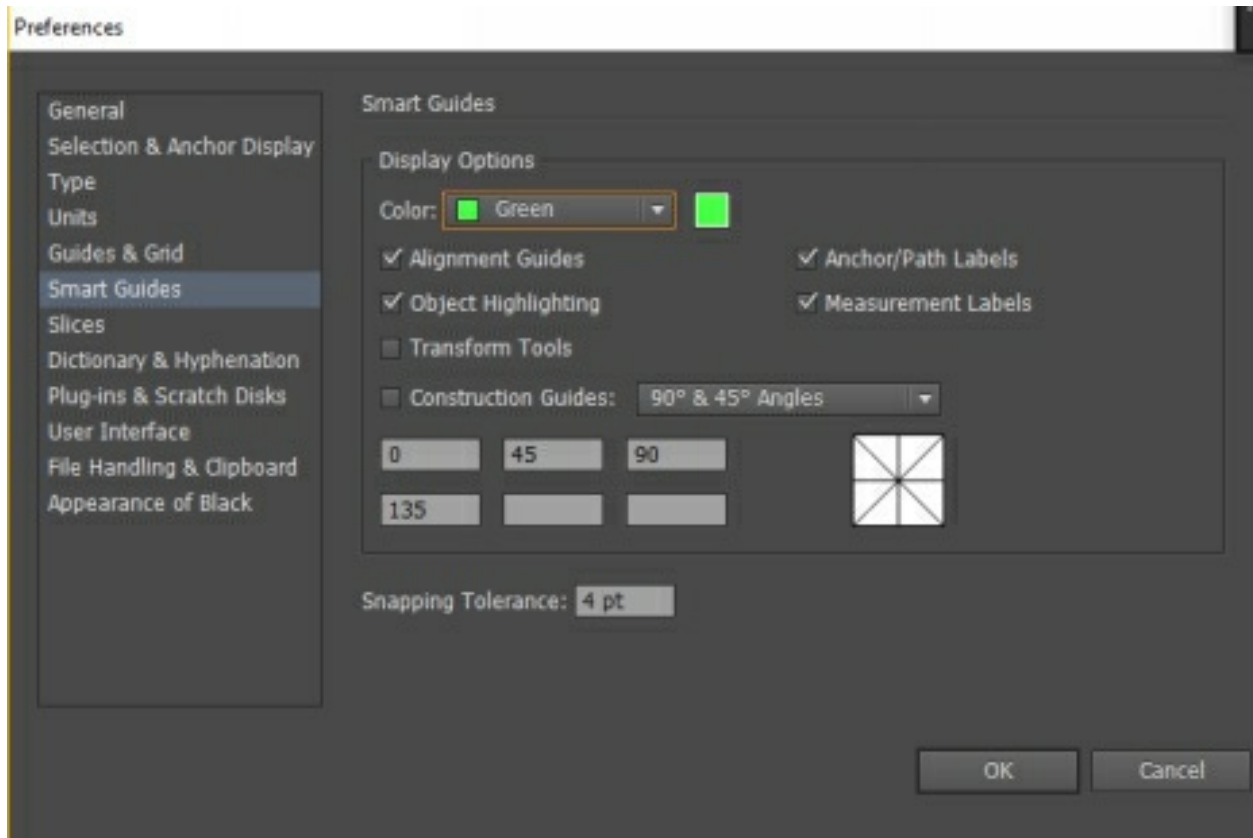
To make use of a ruler is simple using the Illustrator.

1. Start by clicking the View tab on the screen, then choose Rulers.
2. A drop-down appears, click on the show or hide rulers.
3. Depending on which one you chose, the ruler automatically takes the command.
4. You can change the measuring unit by right-clicking on the ruler. We have points, picas, inches, millimeters, centimeters, and pixels.



## USING SMART GUIDES

Smart Guides are essential as it helps out to create pathways for your artworks. They are the green lines that appear vertically and horizontally, and they show the alignment of your artworks. Quick Guides can be a transformation tool; it can also aid construction and other artwork alignment process.



1. You can activate smart guides by clicking on the View tab, after which a drop-down appears.
2. Choose Smart Guides to turn on or off.
3. You can also change Smart Guides setting by clicking the Edit tab, choose Preferences option on the drop-down options.
4. Click on the Smart Guides option to set the desired preference for your artwork. You can change the color and also the size of your Smart Guides.

## **CREATING STROKES**

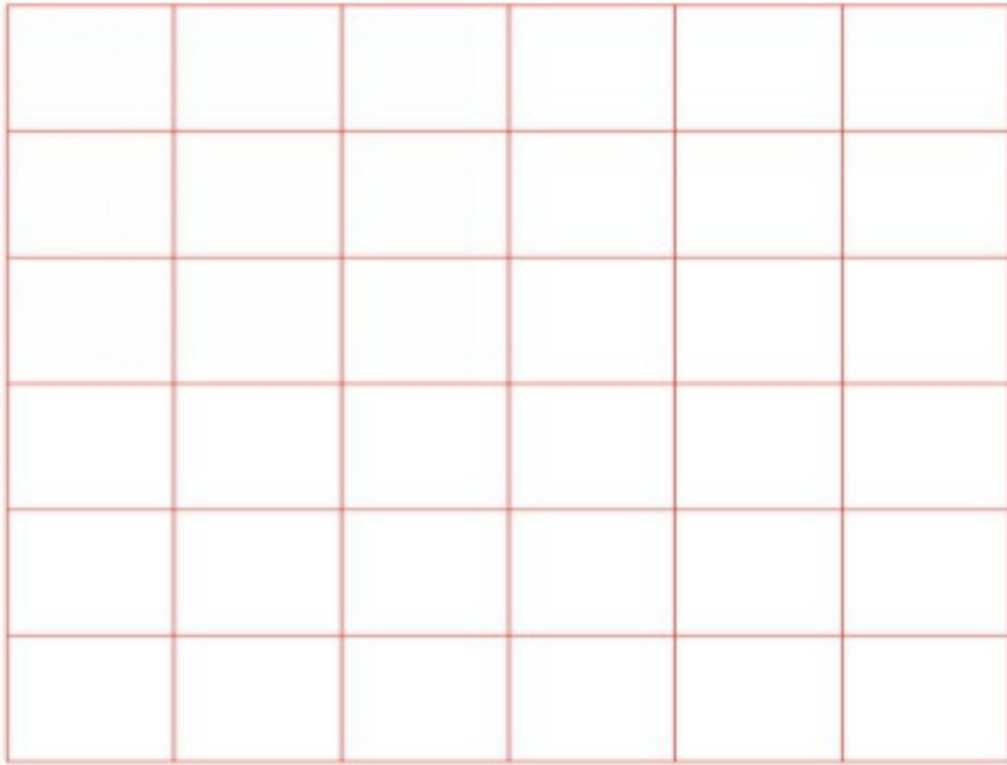
The Stroke panel can help you to understand how dash adjustment works. It tells if a line is robust. Other unique features include the stroke alignment, the arrowhead, the line caps, etc.

To apply a stroke;

1. Select your desired object on the screen.
2. Then, click on the stroke box.
3. Choose from the numerous stroke options as desired and apply them to the desired position in the artwork.

## **USING GRIDS**

Grids are essential features of the Illustrator that allow you to create either rectangular or circular shaped artworks. A unique feature of the square grid is the sizeable number of vertical and horizontal lines, while the polar grid depends on considerable amounts of concentric dividers.



1. From the tool panel, click on the Rectangular Grid tool.
2. Options of colors appear on the tool panel and then select a stroke color.
3. To form your desired grid, employ the click and drag skills on your Artboard.
4. Finally, release the mouse when you are satisfied with the size of the grid.

# 11.

## **DRAWING WITH THE PEN, PENCIL AND BRUSH TOOLS**

**D**rawing your artwork using the pen tool, pencil tool, and the brush tool can be an easy way to produce lines and curves. It also allows for editing and so many other visual features for your artworks.

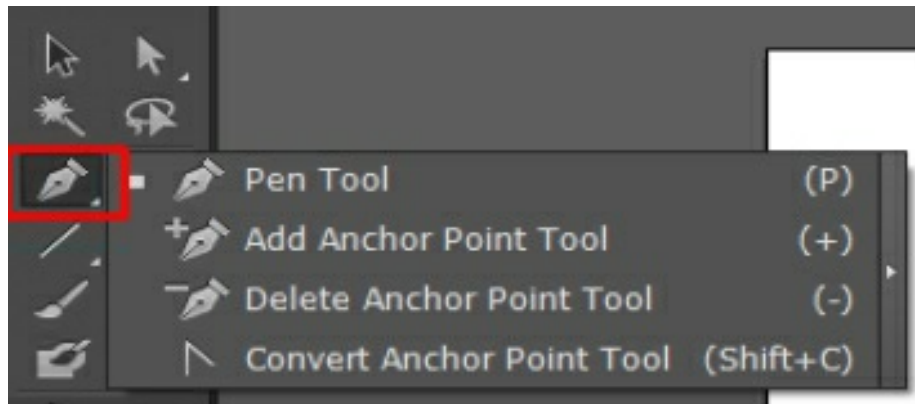
Using these tools allows you to make a flexible design, coupled with other options. As beautiful as the objects created with these options are, the inability to use these drawing tools can be annoying.

The following subheadings outline how to draw making use of the pen, pencil, and brush tools.

### **DRAWING WITH THE PEN TOOL**

Drawing your artwork is one of the ways to achieve your dream design. The

Pen tool provides an easy way to bring your desired artwork into reality. In case it interests you to create lines and pathways for your artwork, the pen tool is a great tool to achieve that.



1. To get started, go to the Tool panel and select the drop-down Pen tool option.
2. Use the Control panel to set the properties of the line.
3. After selecting the desired weight of line and color, click to apply on your Artboard.

### Using the click and drag techniques

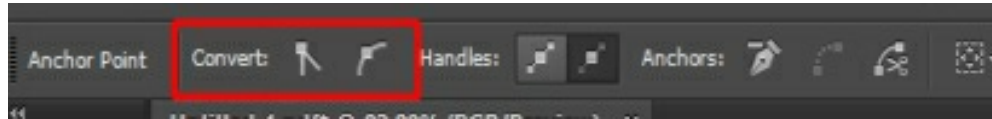
To make use of this technique;

1. Select the Pen tool.
2. Click through the paths that you want your new object, and drag around the paths till you get your desired shape.
3. Select the Direct Selection tool, and double click on the new object and
4. Make use of the anchor handles to perfect your object.
5. After you have begun pulling, press down the **Ctrl** key (Windows) or **Command** (Mac OS) to continue shooting to draw your paths.

### The click and convert techniques

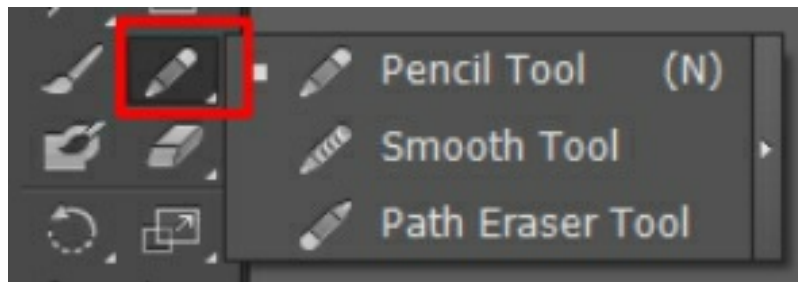
This technique is useful if you wish to edit the paths or convert points created on your artwork. To use the "click and convert" method, the following should be followed;

1. From the Control panel, we have the convert option.
2. Click on the convert option to select the desired converted anchor points, whether to corner or smooth.



## USING THE PENCIL TOOL

This tool allows us to create natural or smooth shapes, lines, and paths. If you wish to explore free forms lines on the Illustrator;

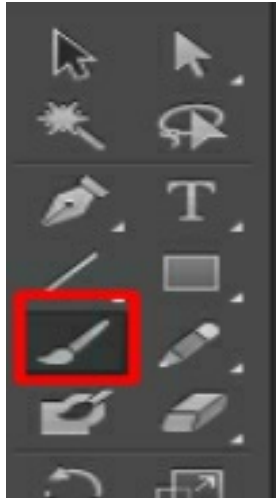


- From the Toolbox in the tool panel, select the Pencil tool from the drop-down box.
- After you have selected the Pencil tool, click and drag to draw your desired artwork.

## USING THE BRUSH TOOL

You can also use the brush tool to draw natural paths for your artworks. It also allows the use of colors for customization of the artwork.



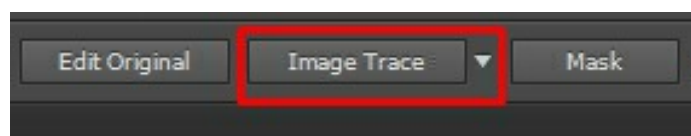


1. Click the Brush tool on the Tool panel, and then select Brushes in the Window tab to get started.
2. Choose and click on the brush tool you desire
3. Situate the pointer in the Artboard to the point where you wish to begin the stroke
4. Drag the pointer in the Artboard to draw your desired path.

## **PLACING DRAWING IN A SKETCH**

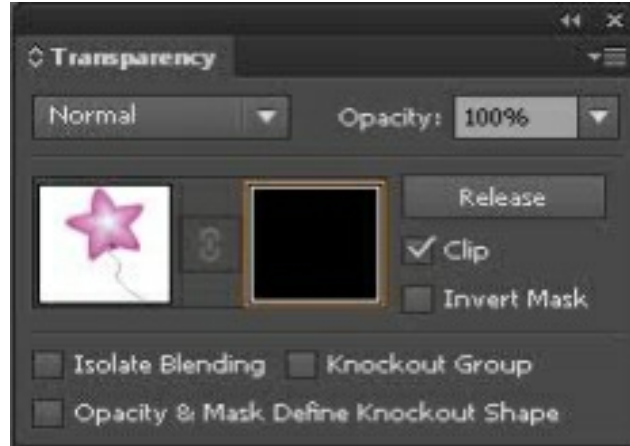
When you've got your image, scan or capture it and view it in adobe illustrator. The scan/image quality will decide how well your graphic is going to be, so make sure you avoid any shadow. The most contrasting scans or photographs between pen and paper will end up being the best.

1. Open and select your image.
2. Click the Image Trace icon on the Control panel.
3. As soon as you click on the Image Trace icon, the picture will immediately change to black and white. You can then increase the size of the image by selecting expand.



## Applying Transparency

Transparency determines how objects' opacity and how they blend to remove a portion covering the transparent object.



Here are the steps in applying Transparency to an object in Illustrator;

1. Input a letter or more than a note on your Artboard
2. Pick window and click on Transparency, a dialog box pops up.
3. Adjust the opacity to give the text the desired level of Transparency.
4. Now, apply Transparency to your image.

## Preparing Layers

1. On the right side of your illustrator window, look for the layer panel and select, or use **Window -> Layers** to open.
2. For each new document in your Artboard, it usually starts with a layer with default name layer1.
3. If you want to change the name of the layer, click on the tier two times, input the name you desire and hit the enter button on your keyboard to save changes.
4. Select the new layer icon below the layers panel to create a new layer.
5. To move text or object from one layer to the other, highlight the text or object and drag to the new layer.
6. To locate text or object in your current document, choose artwork, and select find objects below the layers panel.

In adobe illustrator, you can convert a sketch on a piece of paper into a fantastic artwork in adobe, all you have to do is snap and import the image into Illustrator, and the rest is...well up to you. You can also change any object's opacity to your desired taste since artwork in Illustrator can be stacked in layers. With layers, you have the freedom to move objects from one to another. You can even lock a coat if necessary, to prevent one from affecting another.

## 12.

# THE BLOB BRUSH TOOL AND ERASER TOOL

While your brush stroke might help you create a smooth or natural path, using the blob brush can be filled or compound in nature. It allows for a seamless merger with shapes for newly painted artwork.

The blob brush tool also avails you the opportunity to streamline your artwork on the Artboard. Knowing how to use this tool is essential for you to create paths that can serve multiple functions.

The Eraser tool can help you to erase objects that are on the Artboard. This function is so unique that if an object is deleted in the Artboard and split into different sections, the Eraser tool will help you separate the objects to enable their movement in the Artboard.

## USING THE BLOB BRUSH

When you use the Blob Brush tool, you get filled and compound paths. It doesn't paint as a stroke but as a fill, unlike the regular Paintbrush. You can scale it up and make objects out of it.



In creating a merger on your artwork, follow the steps below;

1. To create a strong under-fill, select the Blob Brush tool option in the tool panel.
2. You can increase or decrease the size of the Blobbrush using the Control panel or by using the bracket keys.
3. Click to paste the path on the canvas.
4. You can work around the anchor points on the objects.



With the Blob Brush tool, you don't always have to color the inner parts of your shape manually; this is because it provides you with the option of selecting, then deleting the outside part of your way, and automatically painting only the Inside of the shape, thus, leaving out the original outline.

## USING THE ERASER TOOL

Have you thought of correcting errors in your design? The Illustrator has got you covered! It is because you can simply erase any part of your artwork. The Eraser tool works as an editing tool to give flexibility and control to your design, unlike the other editing tools, the Eraser tool can help you reshape your artwork.



To understand how to make use of the Eraser tool, you should follow the steps below;

1. With your image on the Artboard, make sure the desired parts to be removed are visible.
2. Make sure you zoom out the entire artwork by using the zoom tool on the toolbar.

3. You can also create a mask on the artwork for secure erasing (optional).
4. Press down the **Shift** button while clicking on areas to add to the desired selected parts to be removed.

It is worthwhile to note that you can use the Eraser tool to create a path. You can do it by clicking on the Tool panel to select the Eraser tool. The cursor becomes similar to that of the brush tool, and you can change the Eraser's size, using the bracket keys in the tool panel.

## COMBINATION OF THE BLOB BRUSH AND ERASER TOOLS

It is important to note that you can use the Blob Brush tool and the Eraser tool in conjunction with one another. If, for example, you want to draw a freehand drawing making use of the Blob brush tool, you can make use of the Eraser tool to carve or cut designs and shapes on your artwork.

Knowing how to combine these two tools can help you draw and carve out designs by leveraging on the Eraser tool to remove unwanted strokes in big and merged maps to bring out the artwork's desired shape. One significant image that you can produce with the combination of both tools is the Teddy Bear.



While the Blob brush tool is a painting and drawing tool, knowing how to combine it with the Eraser tool can help you achieve more complicated

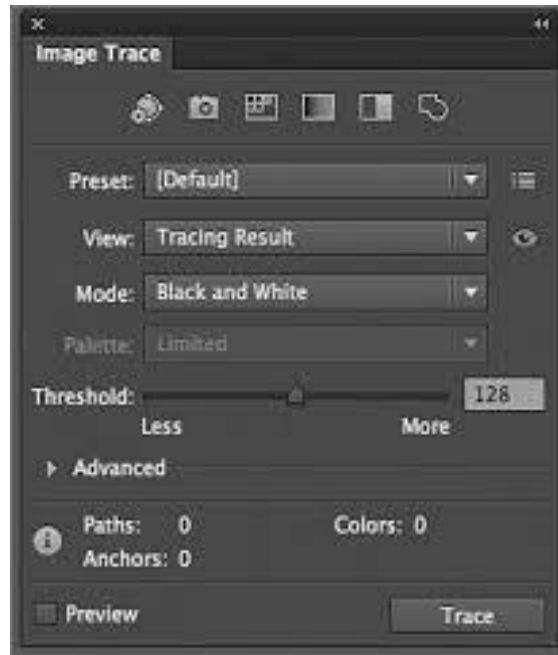
designs, and you would need to do a lot of practice to be good at this.



# 13.

## IMAGE TRACE TOOL FOR SKETCHES

**I**mage trace tool in Adobe Illustrator allows you to do many things; chief among them is changing a freehand sketch or drawing into an alterable vector object. This chapter will focus on the use and importance of image trace tool.



## IMPORTANCE OF IMAGE TRACE TOOL

Image trace tool is essential in several ways;

- It allows you to convert images of just about any format into vector artwork.
- With the trace tool, you can use an image as the basis for your design.
- Once you have your design on a paper or any solid surface, you can easily continue from there digitally without restarting again.

## USING THE IMAGE TRACE TOOL

Here are some of the steps involved in using an image trace tool;

1. Draw on a piece of white paper using a pigmented ink pen and make sure the outlines are as sharp as you can make them.
2. Snap the image you have just drawn; you can simply use your phone to do just that.
3. Now, copy the image into your PC and save it. Then open your

Illustrator and create a new document.

4. Export or drag the image into the new document you have just created.
5. Resize the image and remove unwanted edges and trim down to the area of the image you need.
6. Select the Image Trace panel from the Window tab.
7. Adjust the image to your liking using the settings. You can also preview the image to know how it will look like after the adjustments with the eye-like icon.
8. Under Advanced, you can now expand the image paths using the expand button in the menu to differentiate the shapes in the vector image.
9. To adjust the shapes in the image or color any or all of them, simply ungroup their paths by hitting **Ctrl + Shift + G** on your keyboard.
10. Adjust the image until you have what you like.

## **DRAWING TOOLS OR IMAGE TRACE TOOL**

When you use the image trace tool, what you will obtain is a clean image with all the details straightened, unlike the drawing tool, the image still looks good but not as the one done using image trace tool.

Although most times, you have to prepare your image before you use the Image trace tool that may seem steep at first, it gets better and faster as soon as you export your model into Illustrator. But here is the thing; the cleaner and sharper your images would be by using the drawing tool.

## **SUMMARY**

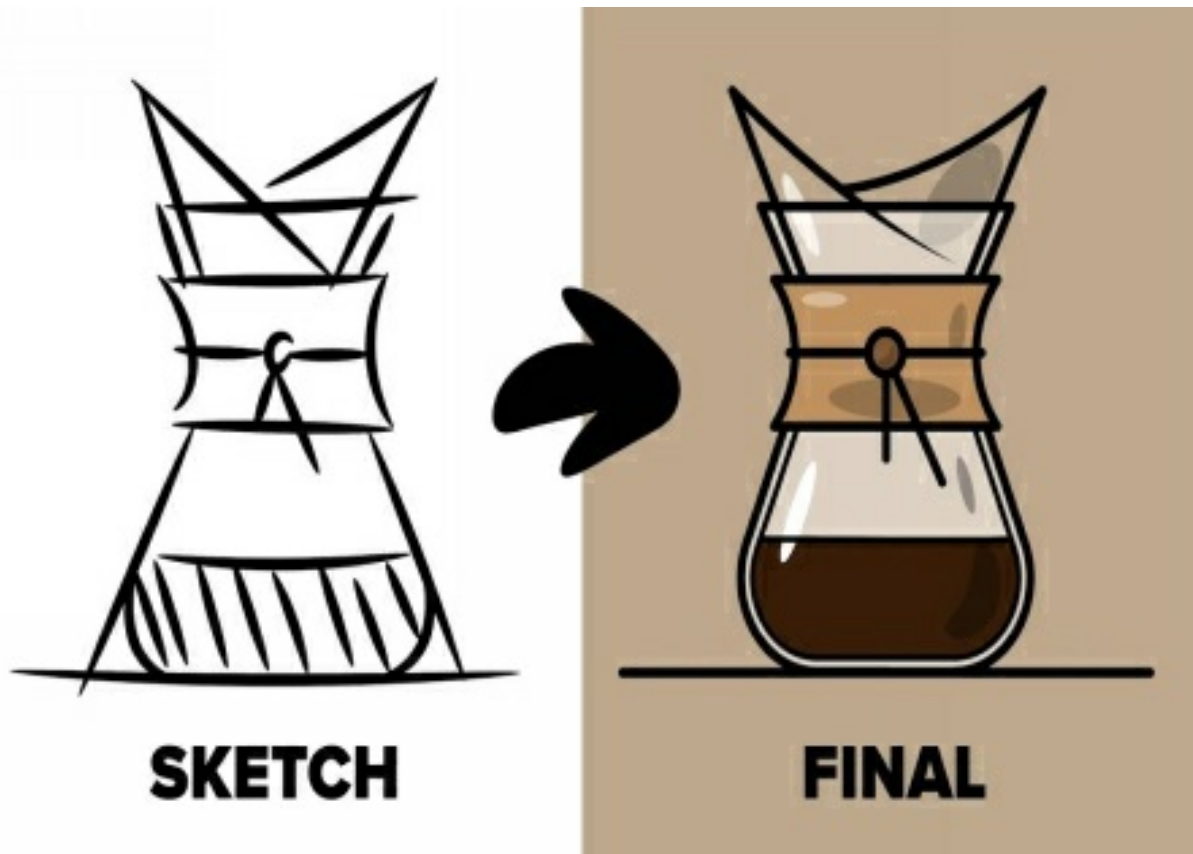
The image trace tool is quintessential in your journey to creating the object or image you have imagined, and the good news is that it is not difficult at all. You can simply draw on a piece of (white) paper and turn it into a colorful

object or image using the Adobe Illustrator's trace tool.

## **14.**

# **TRACING A HANDWRITTEN SKETCH AND CONVERTING IT INTO VECTOR ARTWORK**

**B**eing a designer, you may think of just to take sketches and simply turn them into artwork. Well, Adobe Illustrator made that possible, and all you have to do now is to follow the following steps;



### **Create a neat sketch of your design**

Check your sketchbook for a drawing or sketch you intend to convert into a vector and scan it. Whatever you decide to scan into Illustrator, be sure it is very bold and easy to be seen on Adobe Illustrator.

### **Transform your design into a digital image**

You can do this by simply scanning your drawing. Ensure that your image is of a high resolution to ensure that a precise and better result is obtainable in Illustrator. If possible, go for an all-black ink in your drawing to get a sharp image.

### **Trim your Design**

You can now expand your image and begin to carefully remove any unwanted markings in your drawing by using the eraser tool. I am sure we have thrashed this aspect in the previous chapter. In the end, what you will

have is a clean-cut image ready for complete transformation.

### **Edit and save the Image**

They are a lot of tiny adjustments you may need to do to make your image trace ready. Whatever it is you adjust, look for a way to transform the object into black and white and save.

### **Trace the Image**

Create a new document from your Artboard. Click on the File tab to choose a place to insert the image file, and then use the Image trace tool for image tracing.

### **Preview your Image**

Select preview and pick the preset tab in image trace and check the options available until you find the one befitting your design.

### **Change the traces in your image to paths.**

Once done tracing your image, you simply expand using the expand function in the toolbar menu, and you can convert all image trace to paths.

You can now do whatever you want with the new vector artwork.

### **SUMMARY**

You can convert sketches or drawings into images by tracing, expanding, and converting traced images to paths to obtain a vector artwork.

# 15.

## COMPOUNDING VECTOR SHAPES WITH THE PATHFINDER TOOL

You now know a thing or two about vector shapes or images from the previous chapter. This chapter will focus on compounding vector shapes and how to use it for a stencil.

### **What does vector-compounding mean?**

Vector-Compounding in Illustrator simply means to combine each vector image into a vector sum of the various image vector components or strokes.

### **What are the benefits of Vector-Compounding?**

With vector-compounding, you can easily alter the size and shape of objects.

You can also adjust the position of objects.

### **Compounding vector basics**

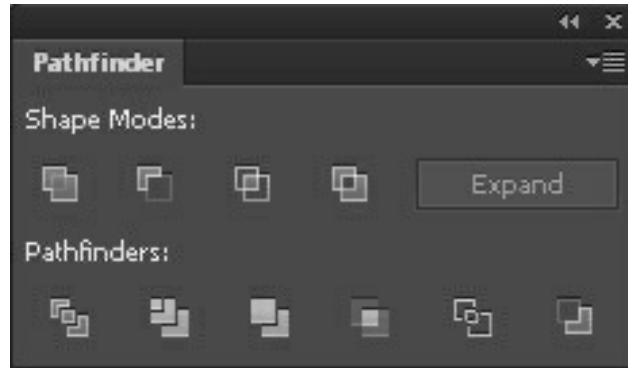
There are many ways you can use to combine objects in Illustrator to form a



shape.

## **Pathfinder tool**

With the pathfinder tool, you can easily merge more than one vector image in interaction mode.



## **Compound shapes**

With compound shapes, you can merge more than one vector image and determine the relationship between vector images. Compound shapes are more robust than the path in that they have four types of interactions: Add, intersect, exclude, and subtract.

## **Compound paths**

It gives you the freedom to utilize one vector object to create an opening in another.

## **USING A COMPOUND VECTOR AS A STENCIL**

Create a new document, choose an image, export it into Illustrator, and set the background of the material. Be sure the image covers the Artboard, select the rectangle tool to ascertain the area covered by your Artboard.

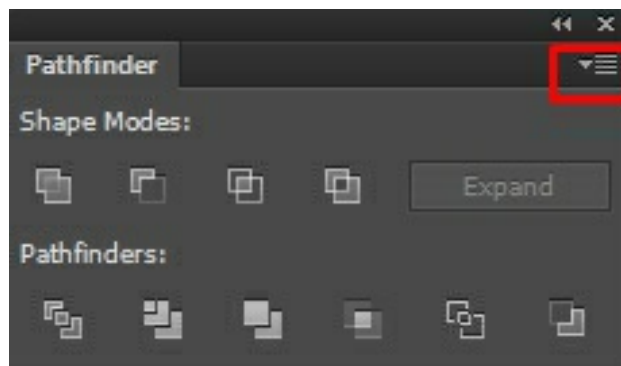
1. Fill with any color and adjust the Transparency.
2. Open swatches and select new swatches, name it, and choose a spot color from the color type drop-down list.
3. Select the Type tool, go back to your Artboard to input text, and

choose a font.

4. Expand to convert the object to paths, then combine them using the unite tool in pathfinder
5. From brush, select a new brush from the pop-up window, fill in the appropriate data, and then hit the enter button.
6. Make a copy of the object's shape and fill with any color, and then adjust the Transparency.
7. Select the duplicate and the original object shape. Open the pop-up menu in the transparency toolbox, select make opacity mask and unclick the box.

## COMPOUNDING VECTORS

One of the sure bet to aid your artwork's technicality is for you to know how to compound vector shapes. It allows you to combine one or more vectors, and provides for their interaction. For you to understand how to reshape your vectors;



1. First, you would have to select the vectors that you wish to compound. You could also add text, envelopes, shapes, etc. depending on your intent.
2. Next, scroll to the Pathfinder panel menu in the tool panel or click the Window tab and select Pathfinder.
3. Select the Make Compound Shape option in the drop-down
4. Finally, if you wish to reshape the components' mode, click on the Shape Mode button in the layers panel.

# **16.**

## **COLOURING A VECTOR DRAWING**

**T**his chapter will focus on how to color poster and t-shirt designs and adding type to poster design.

### **COLORING POSTER DESIGNS**

Creating a colored poster design in Illustrator can be like hell if you are not familiar with the workings of it before. But it isn't as hard as you might have imagined. Here is how;

1. If you are familiar with Adobe Photoshop already, you can create your image from Photoshop and export it into Illustrator. Alternatively, you can snap the picture and copy it into Illustrator.
2. Use an image tracing tool to trace the object. You can use the

black and white mode for the image for a sharp image and easy tracing.

3. Now, zoom in to check the parts of the images and text you don't want.
4. Fine-tune the anchor points, expand and convert to paths.
5. Create a layer and allow it to be below the layers panel
6. Select all the components that you want to combine and use the pathfinder panel to put them together as one vector object
7. Transform your compound vector object into compound paths by hitting the expand button
8. Flat fill them with any color of your choice.
9. Add a background and lettering to your design if you want to include either of them.
10. Trim out the contour on your image, especially the ones you think should be transparent.
11. Ready your file for a printout

## **COLORING T-SHIRT DESIGNS**

You can start by drawing the design on a piece of white paper first, snap it, and then copy and save it.

1. Open the file in Illustrator or simply drag and drop into the new illustrator document.
2. Add a new layer and change the name from the default layer 1 to the one you want
3. Click on the Brush tool on the Tool panel and ink the sketch.
4. Expand to transform the brush paths into objects and combine them hitting the pathfinder and unite icon.
5. Select the colors you want to use, click on the object tab, select Live Paint, and then Make.

To paint an area in one sweep, select the live paint bucket tool and tap the area you want to paint.

Tweak and re-tweak, if you want to add more color and layers, apply shadow

too, and print when you are satisfied.

## USING PANTONE COLORS

Pantone color matching system makes it easy for color matching by assigning numbers to each of them.



Here is how to use them in Illustrator;

1. From the Window tab, select Swatches and click the options icon.
2. Choose Open Swatch Library -> Color Books -> Pantone + Solid Coated.
3. The Pantone solid coated window pops up.
4. In the Pantone window, look for the text box to type a Pantone color number if you have one or choose your desired color.
5. Once you type the number into the text field, the Pantone color highlights automatically. Select the highlighted color, and the object is auto-filled with that color.
6. Repeat this until you have filled the object with the desired color.

## ADDING A TYPE TO A POSTER DESIGN

1. Create a new document in Illustrator and choose a name for your

poster

2. Indicate the dimensions of your poster
3. Choose a background color for the poster using the rectangle tool, then click on the fill color tool.
4. Draw a rectangle over the poster and click on it twice to affect the color selection
5. Copy an image to your poster to be used as a background or an image within the poster
6. Adjust the image until it fits right into the poster
7. Change the Transparency of the object to the required specification.
8. If your design involves text, select the Type tool, and move to your poster.
9. Check the font type and size, whether they are to spec.
10. Align the text with the image and change the background of the book if necessary.

# 17.

## SAVING/EXPORTING DOCUMENTS

This chapter will be about how to save documents and also export documents from Adobe Illustrator into different formats.

### SAVING DOCUMENTS

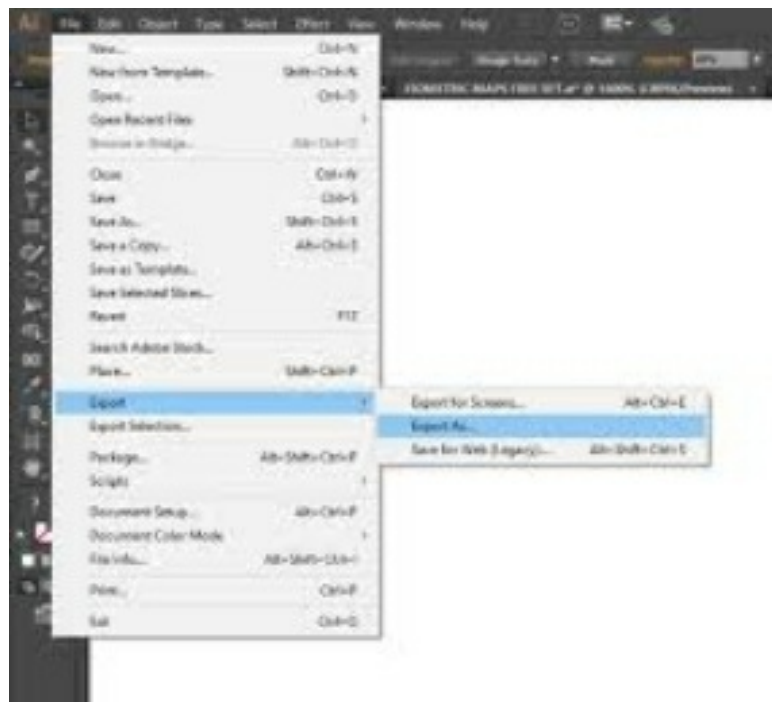
To save documents in Illustrator;

1. Go to the File tab -> Save. Choose a file name, and your document would be saved as the default format i.e., AI
2. Go to the File tab -> Save as. This would save your document in your own chosen format. Choose a file name and a format. You can save as PDF, EPS, SVG, and more.
3. You can also save your file as Templates and for web use.

## EXPORTING DOCUMENTS FOR PRINT

You would be able to export your files in different formats for use by other design applications. To export documents from Illustrator;

- Select the File tab -> Export
- Choose a file location, name the file, and choose a format to save with. You would be able to export to JPEG, PNG, PSD, DWG, TXT, and more.
- Then, save in the destination folder.





# CONCLUSION

The uniqueness of the Adobe Illustrator has increased over the years with the availability of newer versions. This remarkable drawing platform has helped various users create excellent drawings, artwork, and illustrations. To use this platform, you must know the different areas and tools of the Adobe Illustrator, and how they work. This eBook has explained the significant areas of this platform and how they work, including the device, workspace, and control panels, the document area, the Artboard, and how to use colors.

So far, we have been able to brush through adobe illustrator from creating an object to drawing or sketching on a piece of white paper, to completing the transformation into a colorful vector image or text, sometimes a combination of both as the case may be.

Furthermore, you can export documents from other files to create more exciting designs, and these steps are here in this book. You should be able to design something on your own from start to finish by following this guide step by step. Practice and Explore more often to get better.

# OTHER SHORTCUTS

| Shortcuts      | Tools                |
|----------------|----------------------|
| <b>B</b>       | Paintbrush           |
| <b>N</b>       | Pencil               |
| <b>Y</b>       | Magic Wand           |
| <b>M</b>       | Rectangle            |
| <b>P</b>       | Pen                  |
| <b>+</b>       | Add Anchor point     |
| <b>-</b>       | Delete Anchor point  |
| <b>Shift+C</b> | Convert Anchor point |
| <b>U</b>       | Mesh                 |
| <b>\</b>       | Line Segment         |
| <b>Q</b>       | Lasso                |
| <b>Shift+K</b> | Slice                |
| <b>V</b>       | Selection            |
| <b>A</b>       | Direct Selection     |
| <b>Shift+B</b> | Blob Brush           |
| <b>Shift+E</b> | Eraser               |
| <b>E</b>       | Free Transform       |
| <b>H</b>       | Hand                 |
| <b>O</b>       | Reflect              |
| <b>S</b>       | Scale                |
| <b>Shift+R</b> | Warp                 |
| <b>C</b>       | Scissors             |
|                |                      |

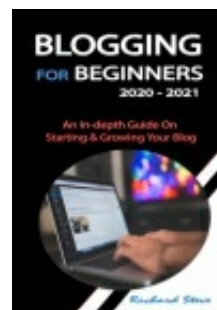
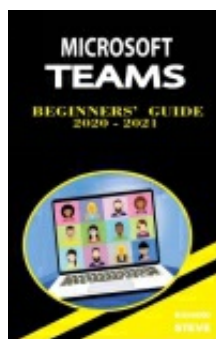
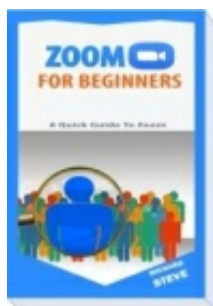
|                |                              |
|----------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Shift+S</b> | Symbol Sprayer               |
| <b>J</b>       | Column Graph                 |
| <b>T</b>       | Type                         |
| <b>G</b>       | Gradient                     |
| <b>Z</b>       | Zoom                         |
| <b>W</b>       | Blend                        |
| <b>K</b>       | Live Paint Bucket            |
| <b>Shift+L</b> | Live Paint Selection         |
| <b>Shift+O</b> | Artboard Tool                |
| <b>L</b>       | Ellipse                      |
| <b>R</b>       | Rotate                       |
| <b>I</b>       | Eyedropper                   |
| <b>X</b>       | Switch between Fill & Stroke |
| <b>Shift+X</b> | Swap Fill & Stroke           |

| Selecting/Moving/Shape/Type                         | Tools                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Selection or Direction Selection tool               | <b>Ctrl</b>             |
| Switch between Selection and Direct Selection tools | <b>Ctrl+Alt+Tab</b>     |
| Cycle through tools behind column tool              | <b>Alt+click tool</b>   |
| Copy while you drag                                 | <b>Alt</b>              |
| To add to a selection                               | <b>Shift</b>            |
| Move Selection                                      | <b>Any arrow key</b>    |
| Lock selected artwork                               | <b>Ctrl+2</b>           |
| Lock all deselected artwork                         | <b>Ctrl+Alt+Shift+2</b> |
| Unlock all artwork                                  | <b>Ctrl+Alt+2</b>       |
| Hide selected artwork                               | <b>Ctrl+3</b>           |
| Hide all deselected artwork                         | <b>Ctrl+Alt+Shift+3</b> |
| Show all artwork                                    | <b>Ctrl+Alt+3</b>       |
| Draw from                                           | <b>Alt</b>              |

|                             |                             |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| center                      |                             |
| Move object while drawing   | <b>Spacebar</b>             |
| Decrease/Increase type size | <b>Ctrl+Shift+&lt;/&gt;</b> |

**THE END**

Thank you for reading this book. I hoped it was practical and useful to you.  
Below are some other books you may have interest in;



[rs.publishing@gmail.com](mailto:rs.publishing@gmail.com) for feedbacks